UNITED NATIONS DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME

PROJECT DOCUMENT

Empowered lives.
Resilient nations.

Country: Bangladesh

Project Title: Aspire to Innovate (a2i) Programme

Project Number: 00098086

Implementing Partner: ICT Division, Ministry of Posts, Telecommunications and Information Technology

Start Date: January 2020 **End Date:** December 2024 **PAC Meeting date:** 16 June 2019

Brief Description

The Aspire to Innovate (a2i) Programme builds on the Government of Bangladesh's efforts to introduce a citizen-centric culture of innovation in civil service to improve public service delivery and make services more inclusive, affordable, reliable and easier to access. In recent times, government efforts have led to considerable experimentation and creation of prototype solutions. This project intends to build on this momentum and provide support to establish institutional mechanisms that incentivize, sustain and scale innovations to attain sustainable impact. In addition, it intends to involve the private sector in this innovation process to improve public service delivery. The project plans to bring commensurate innovation in financial services to support public service innovations.

The theory of change suggests that the project will contribute towards other national priorities including simplification and digitization of public services in rural areas and strengthening good governance in line with the aspirations and plans of establishing a Digital Bangladesh by 2021, SDGs by 2030 and Vision 2041 with an 'Innovative Bangladesh' global brand.

Therefore, with a particular focus on SDGs 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 8, 9, 10, 11, 16, 17 and associated targets, this project will have three components:

1: Institutionalizing Public Service Innovation and Improving Accountability: This component is concerned with simplifying, digitizing and integrating government services to enable citizens and businesses to access them more quickly, affordably and reliably through inclusive physical, online, mobile and voice platforms. An integral part of this will be incentivizing and empowering civil servants, nurturing institutional mechanisms to enable continuous innovation of citizen-centric services, maturing a data-enabled policy environment, and promoting a culture of integrity and accountability.

2: Catalysing Digital Financial Services & Fintech Innovations: This relates to catalysing the development of a citizen-centered, secure and interoperable digital financial eco-system with business processes in place that deepens financial inclusion and offers innovative, pro-poor financial services that are accessible, affordable and reliable.

3: Incubating Private Sector-enabled Public Service Innovation: It will support private sector-enabled social innovations and entrepreneurship to identify and tackle public service delivery challenges by incubating and accelerating social enterprises. A focus will be on scaling up successful social enterprises through commercialization and/or policy advocacy, as appropriate.

Project outcome: Culture of citizen-centric innovation institutionalized and accountability improved to accelerate SDG achievement in Bangladesh

Contributing CPD Outcome:

Develop and implement improved social policies and programmes that focus on good governance, reduction of structural inequalities and advancement of vulnerable individuals and groups.

Indicative CPD Output(s): 2.1) Civil society, interest groups, relevant government agencies and political parties have tools and knowledge to set agendas and to develop platforms for building consensus on national issues. 2.3) The Government has the capacity to develop policies and carry out sectoral and geographical interventions in districts where inequality of progress is evident.

SP Outcome(s): 2) Stronger democratic governance to meet citizen expectations. 3) Institutions enabled to deliver universal access to basic services.

Total resources required:		**70,261,560**
Total resources allocated:	**UNDP TRAC:**	2,500,000
	Gates Foundation	4,244,631
	Vital Strategies	350,000
	Action Aid	100,000
	Government:	50,000,425
	In-Kind:	
Unfunded:		**13,066,504**

Agreed by (signatures)[1]:

Government	UNDP	Implementing Partner
17/11/2019 Monowar Ahmed Secretary Economic Relations Division Ministry of Finance Govt. of the People's Republic of Bangladesh	17/11/19 Sudipto Mukerjee Resident Representative UNDP Bangladesh	N M Zeaul Alam Senior Secretary Information & Communication Technology Division
Print Name:	Print Name:	Print Name:
Date:	Date:	Date:

1 Note: Adjust signatures as needed

Annex VI: List of Knowledge Products Developed in Access to Information-II Project

SL	Publication Name	Type
1.	Public service Innovation lab	Book
2.	Making a sustainable model for G2P payment digitization	Book
3.	South-South Network Good Practices	Book
4.	South South in action: Citizen-friendly Public Service Innovation in Bangladesh	Book
5.	Futures of Education in Bangladesh	Book
6.	a2i Transforming Public Service Delivery in Bangladesh	Book
7.	Digital Bangladesh	Book
8.	Features of Digital Bangladesh	Book
9.	a2i Media Guide	Book
10.	e-Krishi Vision	Book
11.	a2i Success Story	Book
12.	Global e-Indices Rankings and Bangladesh: Indicators for Measuring Digital Bangladesh	Book
13.	Innovation Capacity Framework	Book
14.	A Journey towards Developed Countries: Sustainable Employment Opportunities and Skills Demand in Economic Zones	Book
15.	WSIS Awards	Booklet
16.	iLab Product Showcasing – 2018 and 2019	Booklet
17.	Disability Innovation Showcasing	Booklet
18.	Women's Day 2014	Booklet
19.	UNDP Good Practices in Scaling Up: Scaling-up Access to Information in Bangladesh	Book Chapter
20.	Huffington Post: Innovative Bureaucracy In Bangladesh: An Untold Story	Blog
21.	World Bank Blog: A tech revolution helps boost Bangladesh's development	Blog
22.	International Policy Digest: Bangladesh is Aiming to Lead South-South Government Innovation	Blog
23.	GovInsider Blog: Seriously, Bangladesh is the country to beat on e-payments	Blog
24.	LSE Blog: How a2i is using empathy to foster innovation in Bangladesh	Blog
25.	Global Accessibility News: Web accessibility for universal access to information and SDGs	Blog
26.	LSE Blog: Addressing the migrant skills gap in Bangladesh through mobile and e-learning solutions	Blog
27.	Union Digital Centres	Innovation Briefs
28.	Digital Financial Services	Innovation Briefs
29.	Teacher's portal	Innovation Briefs
30.	Muktopaath – e-Learning Platform	Innovation Briefs
31.	Skill for Decent Employment	Innovation Briefs
32.	South-South Cooperation	Innovation Briefs
33.	SDG Tracker	Innovation Briefs
34.	National Portal	Innovation Briefs
35.	Empathy-base Innovation Toolkit	Innovation Briefs
36.	Apprenticeship	Innovation Briefs
37.	Data to insights	Innovation Briefs

38.	Data to policy	Innovation Briefs
39.	Access to Innovation Overview	Innovation Briefs
40.	Social Media	Innovation Briefs
41.	Service Innovation Fund	Innovation Briefs
42.	District Branding	Innovation Briefs
43.	Partnerships	Innovation Briefs
44.	Quick Wins	Innovation Briefs
45.	Policy Interventions	Innovation Briefs
46.	Service for all	e-Service Booklet
47.	Fish Advice Application	Results Brief
48.	Simplification of Cooperative Registration Process	Results Brief
49.	G2P Payment Digitization	1 pager
50.	Potential benefits of G2P digitization	1 pager
51.	Empowering civil service to innovate sustainable, citizen-centered services	1 pager
52.	Un-bureaucratizing the Mindset of civil service in Bangladesh(10pcs)	1 pager
53.	E- FORM Online application for Government services	1 pager
54.	TCV Studies – 85 published	
55.	Case Studies – 120 published	

1. Innovation Advisor:

The innovation Advisor will **provide** advisory support for the implementation of the programme's initiatives. S/he will be the technical advisor to the NPD and supervise Project Management identifying strategic plan of action to achieve the project objectives. S/he will ensure the implementation of the government's digital Bangladesh agenda. The Advisor will transform a2i to a Centre of Excellence through nurturing innovation ecosystem. S/he will focus on whole-of-government and whole-of-society approach. S/he will guide the project towards national priorities. Project's M&E activities will be supervised by Innovation Advisor. Scale up unit will be guided by him/her providing support in developing strategy and policy.

2. Programme Manager:

The Programme Manager will be the deputy of Innovation Advisor providing support operating projects regular activities. S/he will provide necessary assistance to the component leaders of the programme and the operation manager. The Programme Manager will help translate the plan of action into annual work plans. S/he will manage projects day-to-day activities maintaining coordination with implementing agencies and UNDP & other development partners. The Programme Manager will also take lead in the formulation of additional components within the overall programme framework and resource mobilization.

3. E-Governance Specialist:

The E-Governance Specialist will lead the public service innovation and incubation (Component-1) and the digitization strategy of the government. S/he will coordinate with the ministries/divisions/departments/agencies of the government. The E-Governance Specialist will be responsible to bring changes in the service delivery process through Service Process Simplification with special emphasize on G2B services in collaboration with the relevant government agencies. S/he will also provide implementation support of the simplified services at local and central administration. S/he will lead the initiatives for digitalization of simplified e-services, support development of large-scale IT Systems and E-Service Frameworks and other e-service initiatives. S/He will also perform other related duties and responsibilities as and when required assigned by project management.

4. E-service Strategist

The e-Service Strategist will lead the e-Service capacity development initiatives for the government sector. The focus of this capacity development activities will be to simplify service process, design e-Services, develop, plan and implement e-Service related trainings in the government. Moreover, s/he will provide effective support to the programs to ensure rapid e-Service implementation in different sectors of the government. Besides, s/he will closely work with concern agencies/departments to develop effective methodology, culture and support programs for rapid e-Service development and implementation of the public services ensuring their complete ownership and leadership.

5. Civil Service Innovation Specialist:

The Civil Service Innovation Specialist will be responsible for ensuring innovation in civil service and establishing the culture of innovation in government's service delivery process. Through this initiative government officials will be trained for establishing innovative culture and appreciating innovative initiatives in government office premises. Also, the person will be working for the development of Digital Centres and UDCs to reach community and ensuring proper access to the government and private services. These centres are also ensuring financial inclusion for the rural people by introducing agent banking services and delivering social safety net allowances.

6. Social Innovation Specialist:

The Social Innovation Specialist will lead Social Innovation incubation (Component-2). S/he will coordinate social innovation initiatives in civil services and private sectors for better service delivery, coordinate to institutionalize innovation in private sector with the leadership of relevant government and private industries. S/he will also mentor the teams for minimizing coordination gaps. S/he will also provide managerial support to incubate innovations, establish i-Lab management structure and industry linkage with i-Lab products. S/he will also coordinate to minimize internal coordination gap among the sectors of i-Lab and with other relevant external organizations and teams. S/he will also coordinate govpreneurship in public sector, coordinate

partnership among public and private sector, use social media in public and private sector and implement e-learning in training institutes.

7. Innovation Capacity Development Specialist:
The Innovation Capacity Development Specialist will be responsible mainly for the curriculum and training design to foster public and private sector innovation. S/he will also do the arrangement and management of Service Innovation Workshops while strengthening partnerships for public and private sector innovation. Also his/her scope of work will include tasks such as: maintaining necessary documentations, further extension of Facilitators' Pool and provide support to institutionalize the Pool through Ministry of Public Administration, developing of workshop reading training materials and manuals, developing and maintenance of innovation training database and performing other related duties and responsibilities as and when assigned by project management.

8. Service Digitization Officer:
The Service Digitization Officer will scale up the completed SIF projects in liaison with relevant Government organization, NGOs, startup companies and sourcing fund from different donors where required. S/he will also establish a Disability Innovation Lab+ which will promote innovations for the disabled people, coordinate Challenge Fund awarded projects and ensure scale up of it, explore cooperation and support from International Communities and Innovation Champions and function as an effective team member of Innovation component of the project.

9. Programme Coordinator (Innovation):
The Programme Coordinator (Innovation) will lead the software based innovative projects monitoring and coordination team, coordinate with the relevant stakeholders (Ministries, Directorates, Cabinet Division, Vendor, other implementing partners etc), support technological solutions with a focus on target population, supervise the development teams and lead the critical areas of coding, advise software engineers during software development, lead the technical team preparing all types of standard technical specification in different SDLC phases like URS, SRS,SDD etc. S/he will also lead the technical team preparing Project Scope, Project Plan, and Budget, Risk analysis, Stakeholder Analysis, Implementation plan and relevant strategy for Project Management, provide support to capacity development by coaching government ICT focal points on all issues related to ensuring proper function of the e-service system on web portals or in mobile devices or in client-server model.

10. Service Digitization Specialist:
The Service Digitization Specialist will be responsible for the support of the development of mobile/ electronic service (with particular focus on mobile platforms) related initiatives for citizen and businesses at Upazila, District and Division level offices. S/he will also coordinate with relevant government agencies to provide assistance for UAT, POC piloting & necessary implimentation support for mobile/ electronic services at Upazila, District and Division level offices especially citizen service providing organization. Other scope of works will include cordinating e-court initiatives, assisting implementation of e-file in the government offices, functioning as an effective team member of e-Service component of the project and performing other related duties and responsibilities as and when required assigned by project management.

11. Human Development (HD) Media Manager:
The Human Development (HD) Media Manager will be responsible, as a focal person, to ensure regular HDM production and effective management of traditional and new media. The person will ensure a 360 degree communication of developed contents for media. S/he will do the necessary actions for branding HD Media and arrange awareness raising campaigns for citizens. S/he will ensure partnership with ministries and other govt. organizations with a2i. In a nutshell, the person will create a brand image of a2i among the citizens and enhance partnership with govt. stakeholders using the Human Development Media.

12. Programme Specialist, Digital Financial Service:
The Programme Specialist, Digital Financial Service is responsible to coordinate and lead the digital financial service initiatives of a2i. S/he is responsible to initiate and implement different digital financial service activities including citizen-centric financial product and service innovation, payment digitization, behavioral change communication on banking services, rural e-commerce, develop partnership with different public &

private financial service providers and facilitating necessary policy and regulatory reforms. The Programme Specialist is also responsible to provide technical guidance and support to the team members to achieve the planned activities and financial service integration from digital center.

13. Communication Officer:

The Communication Officer of a2i will be responsible for raising awareness about a2i initiatives in the country, positioning a2i as a trusted and credible partner of Governments Digital Bangladesh Vision. To accomplish this goal, the person will maintain a close working relationship with Media, Government, Development Partners and other stakeholders for mentoring, guidance and support for key communication tools. Also, s/he will organize the national event and will build active working relationship with different government wings. To summarize, the incumbent will develop and implement communication strategy for a2i to create a smooth network for both national and international communication.

14. Policy Specialist

The Policy Specialist will be responsible for coordinating the 'Skills for Decent Employment' Lab+. S/he will play a significant role in reshaping Skills Development (TVET) through appropriate planning, monitoring, coordination and policy formulation. S/he will establish partnerships with various organizations and development partners to create the necessary linkages between skills development agencies and job providers to pave the way for the youths and workers to get gainful employment in different industries. S/he will also be responsible for the 'South-South & Triangular Cooperation' initiative of a2i, where s/he will facilitate South-South Cooperation among countries of the Global South and enable these exchanges of knowledge, skills, resources, and technical know-how through matchmaking process.

15. Educational Innovation Officer:

The Educational Innovation Officer will have a Sound knowledge and proven practical experience in ICT for Education development initiative. S/he will design ICT in Education training manual/teacher's guide or capacity development program for school leaders, teachers, education officers or relevant stakeholders. S/he will also be coordinating educational website/e-learning platform/educational blog/or other social media platform to promote quality and sustainable teaching and learning. S/he will handle and design the largest nation owned educators' platform called Teachers Portal and business model of the national teenager's platform for 29 million adolescents called 'Konnect' (www.konnect.edu.bd). S/he will conduct training, training of trainers (ToT), arranging conference, seminar, symposium, webinar etc. for professional development. S/he will communicate and make partnership with concern ministries, directorates and training institutes of government as well as development partners working with education and skills development.

16. E-learning Specialist:

The E-learning Specialist is responsible for designing and conducting appropriate research initiatives for e-service delivery and policy formulation. S/he will provide advisory/policy support to respective ministries and divisions with guidance from the Programme Advisor/Director. S/he will also provide guidance to develop an e-learning platform for the different stakeholders, capture local and international best practices and extract lessons for policy input and draft policy documents. Drafting new strategies for ICT4D and ICT4E initiatives and coordinating crosscutting policy initiatives among stakeholders are also the important responsibilities of his/her job. S/he will function as an effective team member of Innovation component of the project and perform other related duties and responsibilities as and when required assigned by project management.

17. e-commerce Specialist

The e-Commerce Specialist will work on the development of effective mobile/digital commerce platform to create assisted and direct digital commerce ecosystem in the union, upazila as well as district levels. S/he will also coordinate with relevant government agencies as well as commercial entities to develop the necessary logistical as well as trading infrastructure to enable union level digital centres as a hub for digital commerce. The incumbent will help in coordinating access to mobile services initiatives and support in creating easy to access mobile based platforms for m-service delivery. S/he will assist the implementation of ek-Shop in Union Digital Centers as well as integrate with leading e-Commerce Platforms and function as an effective team member of digital access component of the project & perform other related duties and responsibilities as and when required assigned by project management.

18. Head of Technology (iLab)

The Head of Technology (iLab) will design the innovation strategy of the i-Lab considering the frugal innovation of 4th industrial revolution. S/he will define key priority research questions, identify priority sectors, provide guidelines on technological solutions with a focus on target population, carry out Research & Development (R&D) activities on feasible technologies for Bangladesh, provide guidance in capacity development by coaching government ICT focal points on all issues related to ensuring proper function of the e-service system, develop proposals for funding based on the identified innovation strategy and work with partners.

19. Programme Associate:

A Programme Associate will prepare communication strategies and materials to promote innovation fund initiatives to potential innovators, prepare strategies and design events to promote successful products from innovation fund initiatives to potential scale up partners, facilitate idea collection and proposal development targeted towards innovation fund initiatives while facilitating the innovation fund proposal screening, selection, and awarding process. S/he will also provide support to the Innovation Fund Manager in establishing the Innovation secretariat, establish an agriculture focused unit within the Innovation component of the project, and function as an effective team member of Innovation component of the project.

20. Data Innovation Specialist:

The Data Innovation Specialist will be responsible to lead the Data Innovation initiatives of the project. S/he will facilitate evidence-based policy making and budgeting supplemented by intelligent and predictive service delivery platforms based on data. S/he will also be responsible to standardize, digitize and integrate government data management systems, catalyse the availability of local/national datasets to the SDG Tracker. S/he will support government, private sector and academia to attain data literacy, science, analytics and visualization skills with an added focus on big data. S/he will facilitate to build the capacity of government and academia to apply rigorous techniques such as Behavioural Insights and RCTs to design/redesign and simplify services in a more citizen-centric manner.

21. Programme Implementation Specialist

The Programme Implementation Specialist will Design and provide technical support in implementing project strategies. S/he will oversee the operations of the project, evaluate the different initiatives of a2i and track the progress of the different initiatives. S/he will also oversee the project M&E, research and results management. S/he will also provide support to the Policy Advisor in managing the initiatives within a2i. Ensuring necessary analysis and report for the Policy Advisor in all matters of importance. His/her responsibility will also include ensure joint analysis and necessary support to the Policy Advisor in rising necessary funding from government and other donors.

22. Knowledge Management Associate:

The Knowledge Management Associate will manage the data of the project's different initiatives to help teams for making data driven decision making practices internally using analysis and visualization of data to take decisions effectively and track teams' progress and help team to take implementation strategies for better implementation of the initiatives. H/she will also manage Quarterly Progress Review meetings organized for the progress monitoring of the teams. S/he will manage the indicator sheets of the teams. S/he will also implement Data Dashboards in collaboration with technology team where a2i teams, especially senior management officials, will be able to see and measure the progress of major initiatives/products of a2i programme. S/he will also prepare and manage quarterly/annual/need-based progress reports for the relevant government agencies, manage data quality, data analysis and visualization. S/he will also lead organizing Project Steering Committee (PSC) and other management meetings and tracking the decisions of the meetings for the better monitoring of the project's initiatives.

23. M&E Officer:

The M&E Officer will develop, update and implement the Monitoring, Evaluation and Results Management Framework for the project and all its initiatives, coordinate and implement the M&E related activities of the project, manage internal and external research, assessments, baselines, scale-up studies and evaluations while contributing to the capacity development of project staff around the themes of monitoring and results management.

I.

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মোঃ মাহবুবুর রহমান
সিনিয়র সহকারী প্রধান
তথ্য ও যোগাযোগ প্রযুক্তি বিভাগ
গণপ্রজাতন্ত্রী বাংলাদেশ সরকার

I. DEVELOPMENT CHALLENGE

There is an urgent need for more efficient and inclusive public service delivery institutions that will deliver the level and quality of services necessary to support the population of a middle-income country. Factors contributing to the key problem that this programme addresses, i.e. weak performance of government services in addressing the needs of underserved communities in Bangladesh, include an archaic public service delivery model that poses fundamental challenges to promoting access for financially and socially disadvantaged groups. Their illiteracy rate is quite high, and additionally they often lack power and self-confidence, and suffer physical, institutional and social constraints. The conventional process requires the citizen to appear before one or more public officials' multiple times during office hours, fill in complicated forms, obtain authentication/notarization from government agents, and often wait in long lines. This face-to-face delivery model makes services less accessible to a large segment of the population who are either unable or face substantial difficulties to undertake travel to government offices.

Complicated administrative processes also give rise to the need for intermediaries to steer the recipient through a difficult and often non-transparent series of hurdles. These intermediaries not only increase the cost of service for the recipient but also further incentivize vested interests to maintain the status-quo.

As in many developing countries, public sector services in Bangladesh tend to be siloed. Inside the government machinery, the effects of these silos can be difficult to perceive, but the impacts become clearer closer to citizens, the end users. When public services are layered on top of each other, and designed and delivered in a fragmented fashion, value for citizens falls through the cracks. Yet, the sole reason that public services exist is to benefit citizens at different stages of their lives in a meaningful way. Those in the most vulnerable positions, particularly rural women, children and the elderly are usually the ones who suffer most from fragmentation, and are usually some of the biggest service recipients. Consequently, public services can add complexity to already difficult lives (for example, through opaque and convoluted application procedures, lack of information, etc.), rather than helping people to find sustainable solutions.

Even though the government offices have published Citizens' Charter, there is also no systematic mechanism to submit grievances against the Charters and receive redress. Also, despite attempts to implement the National Integrity Strategy, lack of transparency and accountability abounds in public and private spheres of society in general.

In this day and age of alternative service delivery options and the nearly ubiquitous presence of digital technologies, Bangladeshi citizens are no longer complacent about government services which have traditionally been slow and unresponsive. Despite achieving rapid successes in terms of introducing numerous technology-based solutions, their reach and impact have lagged behind.

Incentives to innovate are also lacking in the public sector. The pervasive, rule-based and hierarchical culture discourages innovators and potential change makers from within the government from breaking the established order. Thus, most civil servants feel that maintaining the status quo is the safest mode of operation. To put it simply, while one may not necessarily be rewarded for improving something, they can certainly expect to incur punitive measures if the attempt at improvement is unsuccessful, especially as it is deemed to exhibit a lack of respect for the established way of doing things.

Lack of a data-enabled policy environment is leading to prevalence of resource allocation decisions and policy making based on gut instinct or intuition. Lack of standard approaches and protocols, territoriality and inconsistency in format leads to duplication and inadequate use of data by other agencies. The data that ultimately lands on the tables of decision makers thus usually carry little meaning or value in terms of decision support or evidence.

A significant aspect of movement towards citizen-centric, digitized service delivery includes digitization of payments from the government to citizens and vice versa. The digitization that has taken place in the country so far is mostly in terms of Person to Person (P2P), and not Government to Person (G2P) or Person to

Government (P2G). The poor and unbanked are unable to access mainstream/formal financial services due to weak business case from the perspective of traditional banks. There is also a lack of skills to innovate pro-poor financial products/services resulting in inadequate digital financial services products and services due to lack of uptake/usage. Moreover, policy reform is top-down, regulation-oriented and supply-centric and efforts at digital finance ecosystem building remain fragmented and siloed.

Bangladesh's emergence as a rapidly developing country is shadowed by evolving and increasingly complex socio-economic, environmental and demographic challenges. Although the country is renowned globally as a development laboratory boasting a thriving social innovation scene, it lacks the platforms and channels necessary for grassroots innovators to link up effectively with private sector, academia and leverage the whole-of-government apparatus to solve public service delivery problems. And the handful of aspiring social entrepreneurs that exist find it incredibly difficult to find mentors, secure investment and in many cases, to even start businesses that address unmet public service delivery needs.

মোঃ তাহমুদুল সুবহান
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তথ্য ও যোগাযোগপ্রযুক্তি বিভাগ
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II. STRATEGY

Mission-driven Innovation to Enable Deliberate Systemic Change

a2i will take a deliberately mission-driven approach that produces systemic changes. Its value will be in processes, knowledge systems, social capital, ways of doing things that enable new ways of transacting, knowing, developing for the citizens for whom the initiatives are aimed. It will attempt to learn through experiments and enters spaces where there is a policy vacuum or lack in capacity, and leverage the value of its process and experimentation by "turning practice into policy". In this respect, the project can be viewed as a 'capacity'. The project will strengthen public institutions by deliberately transferring this 'capacity' to 'change agents' who can then serve as 'change ambassadors' to cascade this capacity to other change agents, thereby creating an avalanche effect.

Making 'Government as a Platform' to Reduce TCV Dramatically

The foundational work of Access to Information Programme namely national portal, e-Nothi, EkSheba, Citizen Core Data Structure, Civil Registration and Vital Statistics, shared G2P architecture, among others, have created opportunities to establish 'Government as a Platform' in Bangladesh. A series of shared APIs and a host of departmental registers will be developed, with the foundational ones directly by a2i and the sectoral ones by respective departments with technical guidance from a2i. This can dramatically reduce time, cost and visits by citizens through unprecedented data sharing, secure central authentication, collaborative design and development across agencies (and increasingly private sector service provider) and integration with social media.

Strengthening the Policy Process to Institutionalize Innovations

The project will support various government agencies in terms of necessary policy and legal reform. In the inception phase of many public service innovations, the policy process is often overlooked. The project will ensure that the right policy process is established in order to scale up the innovations. Partnership with relevant ministries through the Project Board will facilitate the policy process towards institutionalization.

Developing Business Models to Increase Financial Sustainability

The project will develop business models for last-mile public service delivery as much as possible. The business models in Digital Centres will be strengthened by maturing the legal basis of entrepreneurship in the government-hosted centres and by increasing commercially-hosted centres. For many public services, managed service model and PPP will be explored for financial sustainability and joint ownership of digital services by technical vendors.

South-South Cooperation to Minimize Global Reinvention of the Wheel

The project will leverage the South-South Network for Public Service Innovation (SSN4PSI) and other south-south and triangular cooperation platforms to enable countries from the Global South that have successfully tackled public service challenges to "export" solutions to other developing countries. It will also showcase Bangladesh as a Southern pioneer of public service innovation and digital financial inclusion.

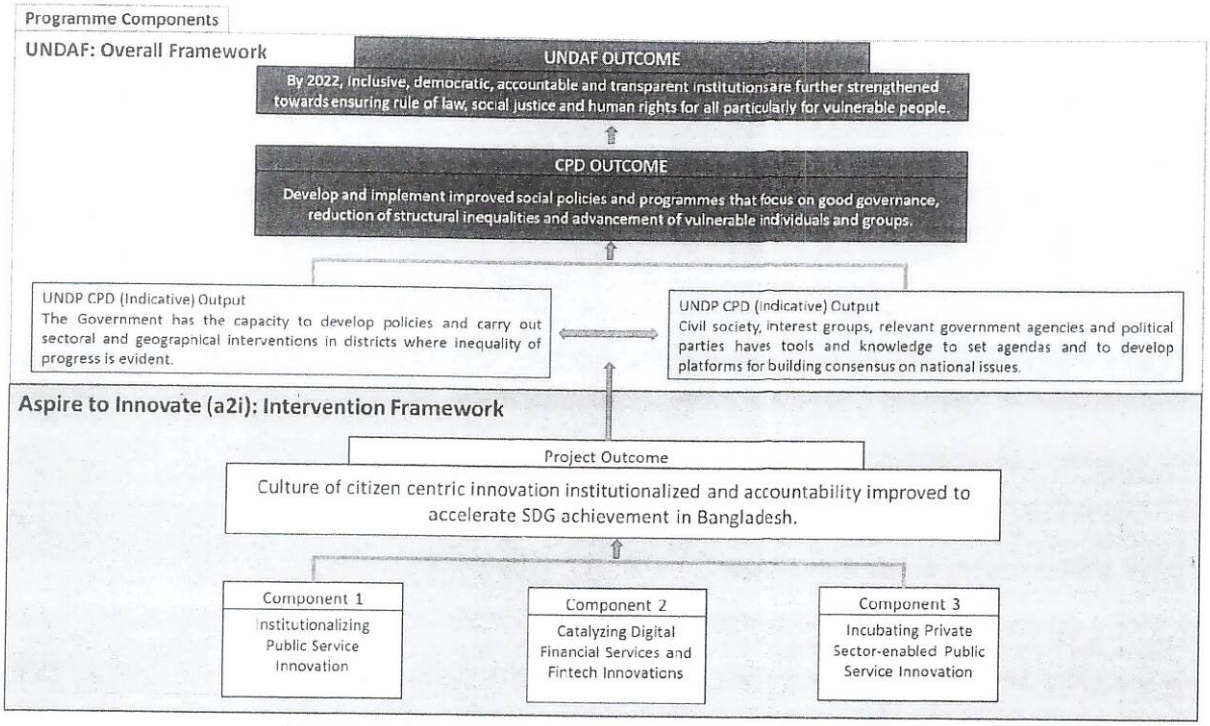


Figure 1: Aspire to Innovate (a2i) Programme intervention framework.

1. Institutionalizing Public Service Innovation and Improving Accountability

This component has two aspects to it. The first is concerned with simplifying, digitizing and integrating government services to enable citizens and businesses to access them more quickly, affordably and reliably through inclusive physical, online, mobile and voice platforms, with the addition of a Grievance Redress mechanism. The second is about incentivizing and empowering civil servants, and having institutional mechanisms introduced to enable continuous innovation of sustainable, citizen-centric services and maturing of a culture of integrity.

1.1 Simplifying, digitizing and integrating government services

The theory of change suggests that simplifying, digitizing and integrating government services to enable citizens and businesses to access them more quickly, affordably and reliably through inclusive physical, online, mobile and voice platforms will be achieved through four interwoven outputs.

First, the project will seek to simplify and digitize government services to enable citizens and businesses to access them more quickly, affordably and reliably. In order to attain this output, the necessary support will be provided to a) simplify government services by wider application of the Service Process Simplification (SPS) methodology currently in use in selected government offices; b) create a near-complete transformation of government services to digital services leveraging frontier (i.e. 4IR) technologies; c) expanding the usage a paperless, e-filing system (NOTHI) to all offices of the government to enable faster decision making by officers in order to drastically reduce the time to deliver services to citizens; d) prioritize development sectors such as land, agriculture and judiciary, among others, where time, cost and visits to obtain services are one of the highest; and e) develop and deploy an intelligent and predictive Integrated Service Delivery Platform (ISDP) that connects all service seekers based on their IDs to a wide spectrum of 2,000+ public and private services.

Second, the access layer will employ models that are self-access by citizens but will also feature assisted access models to ensure that no one is left behind. Support will be provided to diversify choice of access options to offer citizens greater convenience and control through further developing physical and online one-stop shops (Digital Centres and National Portal, respectively); adding a single smartphone application for accessing all government services targeting more urban, peri-urban, literate and tech-savvy groups and voice-enabled assisted National Service Access Hotline (currently accessible through short code 333) for citizens

with low literacy and familiarity with technology. The Cabinet Division, Local Government Division, ICT Division and relevant service delivery departments and agencies will be part of the support ecosystem. In order to attain this output, the necessary support will be provided to develop a capacity building framework to improve the assisted access service points by creating an expert team of Digital Centre Entrepreneurs and National Service Access Hotline Operators.

Third, a digital Grievance Redress System will be developed to allow citizens to submit and track grievances against Citizens' Charters of individual service delivery organization.

Fourth, a whole-of-government systems integration architecture will be developed to facilitate the interoperability necessary to build greater synergy across all government line ministries, departments and agencies, ensure unprecedented data sharing and ultimately provide improved services that are more reliable, affordable and easier for citizens to access.

Fifth, the project will facilitate a marked improvement in Bangladesh's 'Ease of Doing Business'. This will achieved by simplifying and streamlining critical services the government provides to businesses with a particular emphasis on SMEs and social enterprises. The project will collaborate with the Bangladesh Investment Development Authority (BIDA) along with many relevant service provider organizations within the government.

1.2 Institutionalizing innovation and integrity culture in Government

The aspect of the component is based on the theory of change that assumes continuous innovation and improvement of government services need effectively incentivized and empowered civil servants with a strong sense of integrity and supported by an institution dedicated to introducing and nurturing public service innovation. The objectives of this sub-component will be achieved through four intertwined outputs.

First, the project will engage in enabling environment advocacy to facilitate experimentation with and development of multiple incentive models to fit into varying organizational structures within government.

Second, support will be provided with a view to expedite the introduction of clear support structures at the organizational level for continuous initiation and nurturing of innovative practices underpinned by integrity. In order to attain this output, the necessary support will be provided by a Digital Service Accelerator and Innovation Fund.

Third, mechanisms for ownership of innovations will be developed at the institutional level to ensure continuity and scale up of potentially impactful initiatives.

Fourth, the project will support various experiments and develop platforms on data, including data interoperability standards, to solve social and policy problems towards SDG acceleration.

Fifth, support will also be provided to initiate capacity development efforts to equip civil servants with citizen-centric innovation, data-enabled policy making and project management and leadership skills. This output will be attained through a strong emphasis on Empathy & Behavioral Insights Training as well as developing capacity on 'sense-making' and strategic innovation and leveraging social media for public service innovation.

In order to attain these outputs, the necessary support will also be provided to a) trigger public service innovation by identifying demand driven innovations; experimenting with new incentive mechanisms for civil servants, adapting to global best practices; cultivating empathy for citizens' needs and challenges among them; and creating risk space to allow civil servants to experiment with ideas; b) sustain innovation through designing innovations and integrating them into relevant government departments/ministries/agencies/districts; supporting the development of sustainable business models to mainstream ideas and scale impact; facilitating institutionalization of innovations through the inclusion of "sustaining innovations" KPIs into innovation team's APAs alongside the development of a digital tracker

with analytics; ensuring greater fund allocation for innovation projects into agencies' yearly budget; and leveraging district branding initiatives, where applicable; and c) establish an institution dedicated to fostering the creation of institutional mechanisms and an enabling environment in government that is conducive to the continuous innovation of public services in Bangladesh.

2. Catalyzing Digital Financial Services and Fintech Innovations

This component of the project is based on the theory of change that assumes that a citizen-centered, secure and interoperable digital financial eco-system with business processes in place deepens financial inclusion and offers innovative, pro-poor financial services that are accessible, affordable and reliable. The objectives of this component will be achieved through four inter-linked outputs.

First, the project will support the development and implementation of a technical architecture, platforms and appropriate business processes for digital payments and other digital financial services.

Second, it will develop the technical and coordination capacity of regulators, financial service providers and government agencies.

Third, it will support the development and launching of awareness campaigns to increase citizens' understanding of digital payments other digital financial services.

Fourth, it will facilitate the establishment of a Fintech Innovation Hub.

These outputs will be achieved through a) developing interoperable, ubiquitous payment platforms for electronic payments across government agencies, private sector and citizens; b) publishing payment standards and APIs for various public and private service providers to link to the payment platforms; c) supporting financial technology and financial product innovations to improve financial inclusion; d) facilitating increasingly customer-friendly financial ecosystem; and e) establish an institutional mechanism for DFS innovations to serve as a coordinator and facilitator across the digital financial services ecosystem in Bangladesh to support policy makers, regulators, service providers and citizen-clients to come together to innovate pro-poor, sustainable fintech innovations.

3. Incubating Private Sector-enabled Public Service Innovation

This component is about orchestrating a holistic collaboration between government and non-state stakeholders including private sector, academia and civil society to create a well-developed social innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystem in Bangladesh that leverages 4IR technologies and empowers initiatives that improve public service delivery. The theory of change of the project therefore suggests that the objectives of this sub-component will be achieved through three inter-linked outputs.

First, it will incubate private sector-enabled initiatives that prototype solutions using combinations of 4IR technologies to improve public service delivery.

Second, the project will support social innovators and entrepreneurs to strengthen their ability to open businesses and secure investment.

Third, through 360° communications platforms, expand awareness and participation of the youth in forming social enterprises to improve public service delivery.

In order to attain this output, the project will a) cultivating the innovation culture to all spheres of the society through university networks and by leveraging 360° communications platforms; b) sensitizing government, the public and private sectors, academia and civil society (i.e. all stakeholders) on the opportunities and challenges of 4IR; b) create space for joint experimentation with combinations of 4IR technologies and technical platforms; c) providing incubation and acceleration support to commercialize promising innovations and social enterprises; and d) showcasing exciting innovations and overall progress through annual Bangladesh 4IR (B-4IR) Innovation Summits.

III. RESULTS AND PARTNERSHIPS

1. Institutionalizing Public Service Innovation and Improving Accountability

1.1 Expected Results (Digital Service)

The expected result of this sub-component is that "Citizens access simplified and digitized public and private services in a quicker, more affordable and reliable way through improved physical, online, mobile and voice and grievance redress platforms." The project will deliver its support in accordance with the following five dedicated outputs.

1.1.1 Outputs (Digital Service)

The following five outputs have been designed to work in support of the outcome:

a) Government services simplified and digitized to enable citizens to access them more quickly, affordably and reliably.
b) Choice of access options (physical, online, voice, smartphone) diversified to offer citizens greater convenience and control.
c) Standard of services improved by empowering citizens with means for redress of grievances against citizens' charter.
d) Architecture developed to facilitate whole-of-govt. systems integration and ensure interoperability.
e) Bangladesh makes marked improvement in 'Ease of Doing Business'.

1.2 Expected Results (Institutionalizing Innovation Culture in Government)

The expected result of this sub-component is that "Civil servants are incentivized, empowered, with a strong sense of integrity and institutional mechanisms introduced to enable continuous innovation of sustainable citizen-centric services that have national level impact." The project will deliver its support in accordance with the following five dedicated outputs.

1.2.1 Outputs (Institutionalizing Innovation Culture in Government)

The following five outputs have been designed to work in support of the outcome:

a) Multiple incentive models developed to fit into different organizational structures within government.
b) Introduced a clear support structure at organizational level for continuous initiation and nurturing of practicing innovation and integrity.
c) Facilitated experimentation and developed platforms on data, including data interoperability standards, to solve social and policy problems towards SDG acceleration.
d) Initiated capacity development efforts to equip civil servants with citizen-centric innovation, change management, leadership and data-enabled policy making skills.

2. Catalyzing Digital Financial Services & Fintech Innovations

2.1 Expected Results

The expected result of this component is a "A citizen-centered, secure and interoperable digital financial eco-system with business processes in place that deepens financial inclusion and offers innovative, pro-poor financial services that are accessible, affordable and reliable." The project will deliver its support in accordance with the following four dedicated outputs.

2.1.1 Outputs

The following four outputs have been designed to work in support of the outcome:

a) Technical architecture, platforms and business processes developed for digital payments
b) Developed technical and coordination capacity of regulators, financial service providers and government agencies
c) Developed and launched awareness campaigns to increase citizens' understanding of digital payments
d) Established Fintech Innovation Hub

3. Incubating Private Sector-enabled Public Service Innovation

3.1 Expected Results (Private Sector-enabled Public Service Innovation)

The expected result of this sub-component is the "creation of a well-developed private sector-enabled social innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystem in Bangladesh that leverages 4IR technologies and empowers initiatives for acceleration of SDG achievement." The project will deliver its support in accordance with the following three dedicated outputs.

3.1.1 Outputs

The following three outputs have been designed to work in support of the outcome:

a) Incubated private sector-enabled initiatives that prototype solutions using combinations of 4IR technologies to improve public service delivery.
b) Supported social innovators and entrepreneurs to strengthen their ability to open businesses and secure investment.
c) Through 360° communications platforms, expanded awareness and participation of the youth in forming social enterprises to improve public service delivery.

Resources Required to Achieve the Expected Results

The project will be implemented with the support of government employing a finance model that includes private and public resources. Utilization of development finance will be prioritized, including government co-financing to accelerate national development priorities. Leveraging UNDP's position resource mobilization will secure private sector partnership opportunities as well as pursuing non-traditional bilateral partnerships. Total resources required to be mobilized is US$ 70.26M. The present status is US$ 57.2M; of which US$ 4.24M from Gates Foundation, US$ 2.5M from UNDP TRAC and US$ 50.0M from Government have been committed for the Aspire to Innovate (a2i) Programme with US$ 13.07M remaining unfunded at present.

Partnerships

The Aspire to Innovate (a2i) Programme will be carried out in partnership with the ICT Division, Cabinet Division of the Government of Bangladesh, Prime Minister's Office and other relevant stakeholders.

Target Groups and Geographical Areas

This project will ensure that the needs and requirement of traditionally excluded groups, such as people with disabilities and rural women are taken into account. It will have three broad target groups: first, the citizens for whom all e-services and the associated innovations are intended; second, policy level of the government including various relevant ministries reflecting the project's whole-of-government approach; third, private sector, civil society and academia also constitute a second category of target groups for the project reflecting its whole-of-society approach.

The project will cover all 64 districts of the country.

Risks and Assumptions

The programme will be anchored in principles of results-based management and guided by verifiable data and statistics. Quality control by external audits and outcome evaluations, assessments, and social and environment impact safeguards will be enhanced. Programme implementation will adopt a networked approach, facilitating partnerships and lesson-learning across the programme.

Risks: (a) Cyber-attacks are expected to be on the rise as the myriad technical platforms created by the programme become more mission critical for public service delivery, financial transactions and policy making. The programme will ensure cyber security conformance protocols for hardware, network and software; periodic cyber security audits; and adequate human capacity for monitoring and mitigation. (b) Resource mobilization is an emerging challenge as Bangladesh graduates from least developed country status. The programme will widen its resource base, prioritizing government support arrangements and new partnerships with the private sector and emerging development partners such as foundations and social impact funds; (c) Preventing corruption and reducing fiduciary risks require strengthening quality control mechanisms for cash

transfers, undertaking assessments of the financial management capacities of implementing partners, and implementing spot checks and closer monitoring, including audits and evaluations. Building on previous experience, UNDP Country Programme oversight will play a key role in monitoring and managing fiduciary risks; (d) Environmental risk, including extreme disaster, threatens operations. UNDP invests in planning for business continuity and emergency preparedness, contingency funds, and information management. The programme will strengthen existing crisis management mechanisms, including through periodic training of staff.

Stakeholder Engagement

Different types of stakeholders other than the ICT Division which is the implementing partner will be engaged in the project implementation. ICT Division will be the key ministry dealing with technological transformation across the government; while the Cabinet Division will lend its natural coordination function across all ministries and supervision function over field administration. The role of the Prime Minister's Office is crucial for overall guidance and to accelerate the progress of SDG implementation. Local Government Division will help to develop a self-sustaining business model for Digital Centres. Posts and Telecommunications Division will help expand the number of Digital Centres and rural assisted e-Commerce through thousands of post offices across the country. Ministry of Science and Technology and its various departments will be engaged to accelerate Social Innovations across the country.

The private sector (both for profit and non-profit) will be engaged for the design of services, implementation and delivery of services. Development partners will contribute funding and linking to other relevant projects both locally and internationally. Academia and research organizations will be key stakeholders in designing and studying the implementation of innovation projects to extract knowledge and measure impact. The media community will promote services, generate awareness, create demand and facilitate 360° communications.

At the implementation level, citizens' engagement is a central principle of the project which focuses on co-creating sustainable solutions to public service delivery problems and socio-economic challenges. Thus, the project will also create the necessary spaces in its activities where citizens are not just beneficiaries, but designers and knowledge owners.

South-South and Triangular Cooperation (SSC/TrC)

SSC/TrC will play a central role not only as a means to learn from best practices globally, but also to establish Bangladesh's image as a widely recognized Southern leader in the areas of public service innovation, accelerated SDG achievement and leveraging 4IR to leapfrog development. In this regard, specific strategies that the programme will adopt include:

a) Facilitating 'Matchmaking' workshops to enable countries that have successfully tackled public service challenges to "export" solutions to other countries; and
b) Showcasing Bangladesh as a Southern pioneer of public service innovation and digital financial inclusion.

Knowledge

The programme will invest in developing human-centred design, public service simplification, digitization, integration, behaviour insights, public-private partnerships, incubation and commercialization of private sector-enabled social innovations, digital financial inclusion, and data capacity in both public and private sector organizations. Since a well-designed knowledge management system is a priority, the programme plans to be a 'generator of knowledge' for Bangladesh and other countries.

The programme will also reinforce M&E activities to capture lessons from the implementation to develop continuous improvement within the programme. It is extremely important to capture the combined lessons learnt of the various work streams. The results monitoring indicators will be developed during the initiation phase of the programme. The programme will monitor the impact and user perception of e-services delivery through aggregation of existing tools such as service provider reports as well as annual surveys carried out in the field and then shall analyse, distil and synthesize these lessons into re-usable knowledge for sharing within the teams and with government and non-government stakeholders. The programme will also examine

Bangladesh's performance in international e-government indexes to gauge whether actions are having an impact.

Sustainability and Scaling Up

The sustainability and scaling up plan of the project will:

- Through a dedicated Scale-up Planning and Monitoring Unit (SPMU), the project will identify strategies, foster partnerships and develop capacities in public and private organizations, as appropriate, to scale up and/or commercialize the solutions incubated by the project;
- Transfer the platforms, technologies and networks created as outputs of this project to an institutional form of a2i that will continue to integrate and mainstream the various work streams of the project into the government's regular rules of business and working procedures, and subsequently, continuously improve the necessary enabling environment; regardless of duration of particular supporting projects or programmes which inherently have deadline limitations.

IV. PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Cost Efficiency and Effectiveness

Value for money will be ensured through a combination of transparent and benchmarked competitive purchasing processes for goods and services and a robust monitoring and evaluation framework applied to guarantee inputs and outputs remain relevant and realistic within the time framework of the project to achieve the targets in the outcome sphere. In the economy area savings are envisaged through combined use of resources under a single UN framework in the region with physical infrastructure including offices and services jointly shared between agencies working in all components. Government implementation will also offer good value for money with the Information and Communication Technology (ICT) Division acting as the implementing partner and providing physical infrastructure and access to the area.

Cost effective metrics will be designed as part of the monitoring framework with annual reviews and periodic benefit to cost ratio analysis tools employed. Price unit monitoring will be applied by using like outputs of UNDP national interventions and external programmes to benchmark deliverables to ensure cost value for money is achieved. On efficiency and effectiveness levels monitoring reviews assessing efficiency and effectiveness are built into the evaluation plan with annual reviews at intervention and outcome and impact levels that will include value for money metrics.

Project Management

The project will be Nationally Implemented in accordance with the NIM/NEX Manual, implementing partner's rules and regulations, and UNDP's Programme and Operations Policies and Procedures (POPP). The Government of Bangladesh, through ICT Division will ensure direct and transparent administration and management of project funds. Information and Communication Technology Division (ICTD), will be responsible for management and implementation of the project. The Cabinet Division as Responsible Party (RP) will coordinate across the ministries and supervise field administration to ensure smooth implementation of the project. The Prime Minister's Office as Responsible Party (RP) will provide strategic guidance to accelerate impact.

UNDP is responsible for Direct Country Office Support (DCOS) to implement the project activities which is indicated in the budget section. Furthermore, UNDP will provide support for recruitment and procurement services. UNDP may call upon other specialised UN agencies for additional support where necessary. UNDP will also provide resource mobilization services for the project, bring in global best practices and involve global experts. UNDP will appoint a Programme Manager and support staff members to ensure timely and adequate back-stopping to the project. The programme is expected to rapidly evolve to modernize public service delivery and would require recruitment of the staff progressively within the project period. A comprehensive organizational development study will be conducted in the initial months of the programme to determine the exact HR needs of the organization. The HR needs will be reassessed as required with the evolving context in which the programme operates. The ToRs presented in this document do not represent the exact headcount and are indicative of the variety of positions in the programme.

UNDP is also responsible for administration of any Development Partner resources and project quality assurance. UNDP will guide a2i's services to other UNDP projects in the areas of promoting a culture of innovation, institutionalization of innovation, and other initiatives where a2i has developed significant expertise.

The implementing agency ICT Division will manage the programme activities in accordance with UNDP's National Implementation Modality (NIM)/National Execution (NEX) guidelines in a manner consistent with the GoB's and UNDP's policies and procedures. The implementing agency will assume overall responsibility for management and implementation as well as sustainability of the programme results, through the National Project Director (NPD) and the Project Board.

The implementing agency will appoint the National Project Director (NPD) and provide all reasonable facilities and opportunities to the NPD so that s/he can carry out his/her responsibilities in most effective manner. The implementing agency will also ensure that other initiatives and projects undertaken by government agencies in the general area of Digital Bangladesh, public service innovation, public service

reform, data-enabled public policy formulation, private sector-enabled social innovation, digital financial services and SDG acceleration, etc. are fully coordinated with this programme to ensure best results. The Cabinet Division will appoint Deputy National Project Director (DNPD). The project's NPD and DNPD be of at least Additional Secretary and Joint Secretary ranks respectively.

The project will have two specialized units:

1. The Strategy and Learning Unit (SLU) will provide the necessary strategic, policy and knowledge support to the programme components for smooth implementation of the initiatives. This will also include project's M&E and Project Management functions.
2. The dedicated Scale-up Planning and Monitoring Unit (SPMU) will identify strategies, foster partnerships and develop capacities in public and private organizations, as appropriate, to scale up and/or commercialize the solutions incubated by the project through partnership with the government, private sector and NGOs. As such, the components of the project will hand over the successfully incubated solutions to the SPMU for scaling up.

A Project Board (PB) will be in place which will remain responsible for policy and strategic guidance, overall project implementation, linking with national development initiatives and approval of annual workplans with budget allocation. The PB will be chaired by Secretary of the Information and Communication Technology Division. PB may request UNDP for additional support or services, when necessary. The PB will meet at least twice a year.

IV. RESULTS FRAMEWORK[2]

CPD Outcome:	Develop and implement improved social policies and programmes that focus on good governance, reduction of structural inequalities and advancement of vulnerable individuals and groups.
CPD Outputs:	Output 2.1. Civil society, interest groups, relevant government agencies and political parties haves tools and knowledge to set agendas and to develop platforms for building consensus on national issues. Output 2.3. The Government has the capacity to develop policies and carry out sectoral and geographical interventions in districts where inequality of progress is evident.
Strategic Plan Outcomes:	Outcome 1. Advance Poverty Eradication in all its forms and dimensions Outcome 2. Accelerate structural transformations for sustainable development
Project Title and Atlas Project Number	Aspire to Innovate (a2i) Programme 00098086

Outcome 1	**Institutionalizing Public Service Innovation and Improving Accountability**– Government continues innovation of sustainable citizen-centric services at national level for citizens to access simplified and digitized public and private services in a quicker, more affordable and reliable way.

Outputs	Output Indicators[3]	Data Source	Baseline		Targets					Data collection Methods & Risks
			Value	Year	2019-2020	2020-2021	2021-2022	2022-2023	2023-2024	
1.1: Government services simplified and digitized to enable citizens to access them more quickly, affordably and reliably.	1.1.a: # of services simplified and digitized for the citizen	a2i dashboard	370	Dec, 2018	670	1,070	1,230	1,400	1,500	System generated data
1.2: Choice of access options (physical, online, voice, smartphone) diversified to offer citizens greater convenience and control.	1.2.a: # of service access points to offer services to the citizen	a2i dashboard, Digital Center Management System	5,830	Dec, 2018	6,500	7,300	8,000	9,000	10,000	ekSheba system generated data

[2] UNDP publishes its project information (indicators, baselines, targets and results) to meet the International Aid Transparency Initiative (IATI) standards. Make sure that indicators are S.M.A.R.T. (Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Relevant and Time-bound), provide accurate baselines and targets underpinned by reliable evidence and data, and avoid acronyms so that external audience clearly understand the results of the project.

[3] It is recommended that projects use output indicators from the Strategic Plan IRRF, as relevant, in addition to project-specific results indicators. Indicators should be disaggregated by sex or for other targeted groups where relevant. Regarding training, minimum 30% female participants will be considered.

1.3: Multiple incentive models developed to fit into different organizational structures within government	1.3.a: # of incentive models tested/piloted	a2i dashboard	0	Dec, 2018	2	5	6	8	10	System generated data
1.4. Introduced a clear support structure at organizational level for continuous initiation and nurturing of innovative practices	1.4.a: # of innovative ideas funded	a2i dashboard , Idea Bank	240	Dec, 2018	290	340	390	440	500	System generated data
1.5 Standard of services improved by empowering citizens with means for redress of grievances against citizens' charter	1.5.a: # of civil servants received training on grievance redressal	Training report	0	2019	2,850	7,600	12,350	16,150	19,000	System generated data
	1.5.b: # of offices covered under grievance redressal system	a2i dashboard , Grievance Redress System	0	2019	2,850	7,600	12,350	16,150	19,000	System generated data
1.6 Facilitated experimentation and developed platforms on data, including data interoperability standards, to solve social and policy problems towards SDG acceleration	1.6.a: # of data experiments supported	a2i dashboard	0	2019	15	26	39	52	72	System generated data
	1.6.b: # of govt. offices have dashboards with intelligent analytics and visualization developed	a2i dashboard	0	2019	20	70	130	180	250	System generated data
	1.6.c: # of individuals (govt., private sector and academia) gained knowledge on data literacy, data standards, science, analytics and visualization	Training report	150	2019	400	600	820	1000	1300	System generated data
1.7 Initiated capacity development efforts to equip civil servants with citizen-centric innovation, change management, leadership and data-enabled policy making skills.	1.7.a: # of civil servants gained knowledge on citizen-centric innovation, change management, leadership and data-enabled policy making skills	Training report	10000	Dec, 2018	11000	12500	13800	14500	17000	System generated data
Outcome 2:	**Catalysing Digital Financial Services and Fintech Innovations** - A citizen-centered, secure and interoperable digital financial ecosystem that deepens financial inclusion and offers innovative, pro-poor financial services									
Outputs	**Output Indicators**	**Data Source**	**Baseline**		**Targets**					**Data collection Methods & Risks**

			Value	Year	2019-2020	2020-2021	202-2022	2022-2023	2023-2024	
2.1: Technical architecture and business process developed for digital payments	2.1.a: # of underserved citizens received digital G2P payments (in million)	a2i dashboard	1	Dec, 2018	5	10	17	22	24.75	DPS generated data
	2.1.b: # of rural assisted e-commerce service points established	a2i dashboard	3200	Dec, 2018	11,200	19,200	27,200	35,200	36,000	ekShop system generated data
2.2: Developed and launched awareness campaigns to increase citizens' understanding of digital payments	2.2.a: # of unions covered under the awareness campaigns on digital payments	a2i dashboard	1000	Dec, 2018	1500	2500	3500	4000	4500	ekSheba system generated data
2.3: Established Fintech Innovation Hub	2.3.a: # of innovative ideas received technical and financial support from Fintech Innovation Hub for experimentation	a2i dashboard	0	2019	5	10	20	40	60	System generated data

Outcome 3	**Incubating Private Sector-enabled Public Service Innovations-** Creation of a private-sector enabled social innovation ecosystem to improve public service delivery									
Outputs	**Output Indicators**	**Data Source**	**Baseline**		**Targets**					**Data collection Methods & Risks**
			Value	**Year**	**2019-2020**	**2020-2021**	**2021-2022**	**2022-2023**	**2023-2024**	
3.1: Incubated private sector-enabled initiatives that prototype solutions using combinations of 4IR technologies to improve public service delivery	3.1. a: # of private sector initiatives prototyped for public service delivery	a2i dashboard	728	2019	1,510	1,845	3,426	5,272	6,000	System generated data
3.2: Supported social innovators and entrepreneurs to strengthen their ability to open businesses and secure investment	3.2. a: # of social innovation receiving commercialization support	a2i dashboard	15	Dec, 2018	75	100	125	150	175	System generated data
3.3: Through 360° communications platforms, expanded awareness and participation of the youth in forming social enterprises to improve public service delivery	3.3.a: # of youths engaged over social media on identifying and addressing social challenges (in thousands)	a2i dashboard	100	Dec, 2018	200	400	600	800	1000	System generated data

V. MONITORING AND EVALUATION

In accordance with UNDP's programming policies and procedures, the project will be monitored through the following monitoring and evaluation plans: *[Note: monitoring and evaluation plans should be adapted to project context, as needed]*

Monitoring Plan

Monitoring Activity	Purpose	Frequency	Expected Action	Partners (if joint)	Cost (if any)
Track results progress	Progress data against the results indicators in the RRF will be collected and analysed to assess the progress of the project in achieving the agreed outputs.	Quarterly, or in the frequency required for each indicator.	Slower than expected progress will be addressed by project management.		
Monitor and Manage Risk	Identify specific risks that may threaten achievement of intended results. Identify and monitor risk management actions using a risk log. This includes monitoring measures and plans that may have been required as per UNDP's Social and Environmental Standards. Audits will be conducted in accordance with UNDP's audit policy to manage financial risk.	Quarterly	Risks are identified by project management and actions are taken to manage risk. The risk log is actively maintained to keep track of identified risks and actions taken.		
Learn	Knowledge, good practices and lessons will be captured regularly, as well as actively sourced from other projects and partners and integrated back into the project.	At least annually	Relevant lessons are captured by the project team and used to inform management decisions.		
Annual Project Quality Assurance	The quality of the project will be assessed against UNDP's quality standards to identify project strengths and weaknesses and to inform management decision making to improve the project.	Annually	Areas of strength and weakness will be reviewed by project management and used to inform decisions to improve project performance.		
Review and Make Course Corrections	Internal review of data and evidence from all monitoring actions to inform decision making.	At least annually	Performance data, risks, lessons and quality will be discussed by the project board and used to make course corrections.		
Project Report	A progress report will be presented to the Project Board and key stakeholders, consisting of progress data showing the results achieved against pre-defined annual targets at the output level, the annual project quality rating summary, an updated risk long with mitigation measures, and any evaluation or review reports prepared over the period.	Annually, and at the end of the project (final report)			
Project Review (Project Board)	The project's governance mechanism (i.e., project board) will hold regular project reviews to assess the performance of the project and review the Multi-Year Work Plan to ensure realistic budgeting over the life of the project. In the project's final year, the Project Board shall hold an end-of project review to capture lessons learned and discuss opportunities for scaling up and to socialize project results and lessons learned with relevant audiences.	Specify frequency (i.e., at least annually)	Any quality concerns or slower than expected progress should be discussed by the project board and management actions agreed to address the issues identified.		

Evaluation Plan[4]

Evaluation Title	Partners (if joint)	Related Strategic Plan Output	UNDAF/CPD Outcome	Planned Completion Date	Key Evaluation Stakeholders	Cost and Source of Funding
Mid-Term Evaluation				December 2021	ICT Division, UNDP	US$ 100,000
Final Evaluation				June 2014	ICT Division, UNDP	US$ 150,000

[4] Optional, if needed

VI. Multi-Year Work Plan

EXPECTED OUTPUTS	PLANNED ACTIVITIES	Planned Budget by Year					RESPONSIBLE PARTY	PLANNED BUDGET			
		Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5		Funding Source	Budget Code	Budget Description	Amount USD
Output 1 Institutionalizing Innovation Culture and Digital Service in Government	1.1 Activity-Simplification and digitization of government services to enable citizens to access them more quickly, affordably and reliably.	320,770	391,430	385,300	387,110	406,480		DP	71400	National Project Staff	1,891,090
		60,820	122,990	135,990	130,940	125,990		DP	71300	Local consultant	576,730
								DP	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	-
		26,020	44,560	51,190	42,770	34,995		DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	199,535
								DP	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	-
		12,670	16,490	15,690	20,320	16,490		DP	71600	Travel	81,660
		280,780	399,390	400,430	413,320	409,390		GoB	71300	Local consultant	1,903,310
		185,430	455,225	575,890	786,420	355,225		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	2,358,190
		151,860	262,835	306,740	446,100	175,680		GoB	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	1,343,215
		20,120	57,490	81,440	85,760	56,540		GoB	71600	Travel	301,350
	1.2 Activity-Strengthen access options (physical, online, voice, smartphone) to offer citizens greater convenience and control.	65,100	121,870	182,060	119,020	115,000		DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	603,050
								DP	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	-
			10,010	10,340				DP	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	20,350
			8,790	10,340		11,920		DP	71600	Travel	31,050
		58,780	192,510	301,230	312,580	280,220		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	1,145,320
		173,410	250,720	229,805	201,390	175,835		GoB	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	1,031,160
	1.3 Improved standard of services by empowering citizens with means for redress of grievances against citizens' charter.				5,700	5,800		DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	11,500
								DP	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	-
		65,150	110,340	130,430	143,945	152,930		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	602,795
		69,390	105,640	105,540	109,950	100,700		GoB	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	491,220
			14,540	4,640				GoB	71600	Travel	19,180

1.4 Activity-Develop architecture to facilitate whole-of-govt. systems integration and ensure interoperability							DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	-
	94,250	157,980	305,910	305,870	280,650		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	1,144,660
	60,320	62,210	60,280				GoB	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	182,810
	30,270	35,280					GoB	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	65,550
1.5 Activity-Facilitate to improve Bangaldesh's 'Ease of Doing Business'							DP	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	-
							DP	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	-
	404,230	487,840	490,940	497,220	452,530		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	2,332,760
	20,260	21,535	25,190	23,180	21,390		GoB	71600	Travel	111,555
1.6 Activity-Develop multiple incentive models to fit into different organizational structures within government	5,450	10,600	9,650	9,980	8,600		DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	44,280
							DP	72600	Innovation Fund (Grants)	-
							DP	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	-
	263,590	319,330	345,455	341,690	224,240		GoB	72600	Innovation Fund (Grants)	1,494,305
1.7 Activity-Introduce support structure at organizational level for continuous initiation and nurturing of practicing innovation with integrity							DP	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	-
			9,360	3,950	5,890		GoB	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	19,200
	98,460	150,780	165,875	150,000	138,500		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	703,615
	60,580	39,450	42,910	42,290	37,960		GoB	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	223,190
1.8 Facilitated experimentation and developed platforms on data, including data interoperability standards, to solve social and policy problems towards SDG acceleration							DP	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	-
	219,260	249,615	256,015	247,950	243,345		GoB	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	1,216,185
	172,955	271,560	294,130	260,920	242,375		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	1,241,940
1.9 Initiated capacity development efforts to equip civil	239,020	437,465	464,170	456,850	517,460		GoB	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	2,114,965
	237,570	389,320	425,030	445,830	391,550		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	1,889,300

	servants with citizen-centric innovation, change management, leadership and data-enabled policy making skills	359,810	537,150	665,745	661,240	655,750		GoB	71300	Local consultant	2,879,695
		20,310	29,320	25,540	28,540	33,650		GoB	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	137,360
		15,670	22,760	35,670	32,670	30,750		GoB	71600	Travel	137,520
	MONITORING	124,510	198,650	203,260	310,840	215,400		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	1,052,660
		44,200	51,155	54,010	62,120	44,830		GoB	71600	Travel	256,315
		9,560	12,670	10,340	25,290	20,390		DP	71600	Travel	78,250
								DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	-
	Sub-Total for Output 1	**3,970,575**	**6,049,500**	**6,816,535**	**7,111,755**	**5,988,455**					**29,936,820**
Output 2 Catalyzing Payments Digitization & Fintech Innovation	2.1 Activity-Develop technical architecture and business processess for digital payments	126,585	131,050	230,825	241,935	120,750		DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	851,145
		49,035	24,135	15,795	19,125	19,325		DP	71300	Local consultant	127,415
		295,990	411,775	426,661	428,405	430,210		DP	71400	National Project Staff	1,993,041
		253,370	300,720	307,460	326,870	306,790		GoB	74200	Training, Workshops and Confer	1,495,210
	2.2 Activity-Develop technical and coordination capacity of regulators, financial service providers and government agencies	188,650	129,790	213,050	227,960	225,240		DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	984,690
		70,850	87,445	84,210	119,940	71,090		DP	71200	International Consultant	433,535
		45,980	61,920	55,600	67,860	61,300		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	292,660
	2.3 Activity-Develop and launch awareness campaigns to increase citizens' understanding of digital payments	272,840	385,120	379,120	322,310	352,000		DP	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	1,711,390
		25,980	78,650	82,980	80,310	85,760		DP	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	353,680
		102,470	122,550	150,680	150,150	126,770		GoB	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	652,620
	2.4 Activity-Establish Fintech Innovation Hub	16,270	22,550	31,460	32,560	27,230		DP	71300	Local consultant	130,070
		24,440	25,890	26,900	28,900	30,120		DP	71800	National Project Staff	136,250
		25,000	28,000	35,000	32,000	22,000		DP	72200	Equipment and Furniture	142,000
		81,270	345,550	549,460	647,560	445,230		DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	2,069,070
		69,150	138,430	217,210	236,005	214,525		GoB	72600	Innovation Fund (Grants)	875,320
		18,380	20,900	21,000	22,100	23,000		DP	73400	Rental & Maint of transp & o/e	105,380

		41,080	47,680	47,370	42,080	34,970		DP	71600	Travel	213,180
		55,000	55,000	55,000	55,000	55,000		DP	73100	Rental & Maint-Premises	275,000
		10,190	15,000	16,500	15,000	15,000		DP	73200	Renovation	71,690
		25,000	28,300	28,800	30,000	25,000		DP	72800	Acquisiition of Comupter, hardware	137,100
		62,400	65,300	66,500	70,200	72,000		DP	72400	Connectivity Charges	336,400
		18,290	20,650	20,890	20,900	21,100		DP	72500	Stationery & Supplies	101,830
		5,125	5,250	5,320	6,500	6,500		DP	72400	Postage	28,695
	MONITORING	36,780	49,190	42,470	53,540	49,870		DP	71600	Travel	231,850
		30,590	40,250	40,190	38,340	40,650		DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	190,020
	Sub-Total for Output 2	**1,950,715**	**2,641,095**	**3,150,451**	**3,315,550**	**2,881,430**					**13,939,241**
Output 3 Incubating Social Innovations to Accelerate SDG Achievement	3.1 Incubated youth-led initiatives that prototype solutions using combinations of 4IR technologies to accelerate SDG achievement.	236,760	247,380	251,780	246,990	259,600		DP	71400	National Project Staff	1,242,510
								DP	71600	Travel	-
		192,940	288,350	187,380	188,965	173,040		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	1,030,675
		463,730	647,250	757,540	751,660	750,995		GoB	71300	Local consultant	3,371,175
		20,710	25,880	27,890	30,270	20,100		GoB	72500	Stationery & Supplies for training	124,850
	3.2 Activity-Support social innovators and entrepreneurs to strengthen their ability to open businesses and secure investment.							DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	-
		279,930	466,350	438,960	388,680	340,150		GoB	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	1,914,070
								DP	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	-
		203,970	322,770	455,590	434,825	317,275		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	1,734,430
		43,590	85,610	81,540	43,870	40,270		GoB	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	294,880
	3.3 Activity-Expand awareness and participation of the youth in the country's socio-economic progress through 360° communications platforms.	16,130	22,020	28,340	32,310	36,395		DP	71300	Local consultant	135,195
		7,560	6,540	6,520	6,780	6,790		DP	71600	Travel	34,190
		102,450	280,890	275,130	263,980	175,780		GoB	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	1,098,230
								DP	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	-
		310,010	396,180	414,530	388,850	343,780		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	1,853,350
		236,820	396,620	467,720	484,740	386,760		GoB	74200	Audio Visual & Print Prod Costs	1,972,660

	MONITORING	60,395	70,760	80,930	70,770	59,910		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	342,765
		17,840	18,930	15,280	15,670	10,450		DP	71600	Travel	78,170
		6,795	12,670	16,890	19,780	13,370		DP	72100	Contractual Services Company	69,505
	Sub-Total for Output 3	**2,199,630**	**3,288,200**	**3,506,020**	**3,368,140**	**2,934,665**					**15,296,655**
Output 4 Technical Assistance (Operations & others)	4.1 Activity-Operational staff, consultant, travel & internal capacity development	19,170	19,280	29,880	30,050	32,230		DP	71300	Local consultant	130,610
		76,370	186,380	192,840	192,170	192,370		GoB	71300	Local consultant	840,130
		219,890	227,960	228,540	228,770	230,860		DP	71400	National Project Staff	1,136,020
				59,860		65,380		DP	71200	International consultant	125,240
								DP	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	-
		132,890	145,480	157,890	151,690	161,860		GoB	75700	Training, Workshops and Confer	749,810
		5,400	7,890	7,650	7,450	7,840		DP	71600	Travel	36,230
	4.2 Activity-Operations, Repair & Maintenance, Rental, Connectivity	55,050	56,050	56,050	57,250	57,750		DP	73400	Rental & Maint of transp & o/e	282,150
		75,670	76,660	76,690	78,870	80,620		DP	73100	Rental & Maint-Premises	388,510
		16,890	17,505	17,350	18,390	15,380		DP	73200	Renovation	85,515
		100,610	106,610	106,590	108,450	110,420		GoB	73100	Rental & Maint-Premises	532,680
		36,270	46,130	52,790	52,720	52,930		GoB	73400	Rental & Maint of transp & o/e	240,840
		35,670	45,670	65,480	60,980	35,790		GoB	73200	Renovation	243,590
		45,050	45,870	45,890	68,970	33,260		DP	72800	Acquisiition of Comupter, hardware	239,040
		15,470	15,690	15,690	16,690	16,690		DP	72400	Connectivity Charges	80,230
		30,980	37,860	38,690	40,760	40,450		GoB	72400	Connectivity Charges	188,740
		25,430	30,780	35,670	36,750	30,970		GoB	72500	Stationery & Supplies	159,600
		12,120	12,150	12,570	12,750	12,860		GoB	72400	Postage	62,450
	4.3 Activity-Office Equipment, Furniture, Renovation, Equipment Maintenance	61,275	67,175	61,280	66,390	38,280		DP	72200	Equipment and Furniture	294,400
		65,780	67,450	54,980	55,520	39,780		GoB	72200	Equipment and Furniture	283,510
								GoB	72500	Stationery & Supplies	-

								GoB	72400	Postage	-
		65,470	72,390	58,670	59,760	45,670		GoB	72800	Acquisition of Comupter, hardware	301,960
		35,670	35,680	40,790	43,120	32,150		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	187,410
	4.4 Operations, Repair & Maintenance, Rental, Connectivity for Cabinet Division part	47,650	63,530	63,530	63,530	63,530		GoB	73400	Rental & Maint of transp & o/e	301,770
		28,235	33,465	33,465	33,465	33,465		GoB	73100	Rental & Maint-Premises	162,095
		8,750	38,970	6,540	18,970	9,850		GoB	73200	Renovation	83,080
		48,670	61,420	65,340	62,340	63,450		GoB	71300	Local consultant	301,220
		15,670	20,650	23,750	22,450	18,750		GoB	71600	Travel	101,270
		26,850	15,750	10,120	25,430	15,430		GoB	72800	Acquisition of Comupter, hardware	93,580
		14,650	15,670	15,670	20,340	20,340		GoB	72400	Connectivity Charges	86,670
		20,350	25,450	25,450	26,450	20,250		GoB	72500	Stationery & Supplies	117,950
		9,340	12,120	12,650	12,540	12,340		GoB	72400	Postage	58,990
		16,570	23,140	12,300	15,680	4,320		GoB	72200	Equipment and Furniture	72,010
		15,430	20,520	19,690	15,480	23,410		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	94,530
	MONITORING	5,780	7,630	6,570	7,690	6,350		DP	71600	Travel	34,020
		166,235	173,390	174,040	170,950	175,255		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	859,870
	MONITORING (Cabinet Div)	20,630	26,540	25,520	28,590	26,940		GoB	71600	Travel	128,220
		33,250	63,240	67,580	65,580	66,580		GoB	72100	Contractual Services Company	296,230
	Sub-Total for Output 4	**1,609,185**	**1,922,145**	**1,978,055**	**1,976,985**	**1,893,800**					**9,380,170**
Evaluation *(as relevant)*	EVALUATION (Mid & End Line Evaluation)			185,484		207,550		DP	74100	Professional Services	393,034
								GoB	74100	Professional Services	-
General Management Support (GMS)	8% on Cost Sharing	189,628	251,772	299,995	294,890	279,355		DP	75100	Facilities & Admin – Service	**1,315,640**
TOTAL		**9,919,733**	**14,152,712**	**15,936,540**	**16,067,320**	**14,185,255**					**70,261,560**

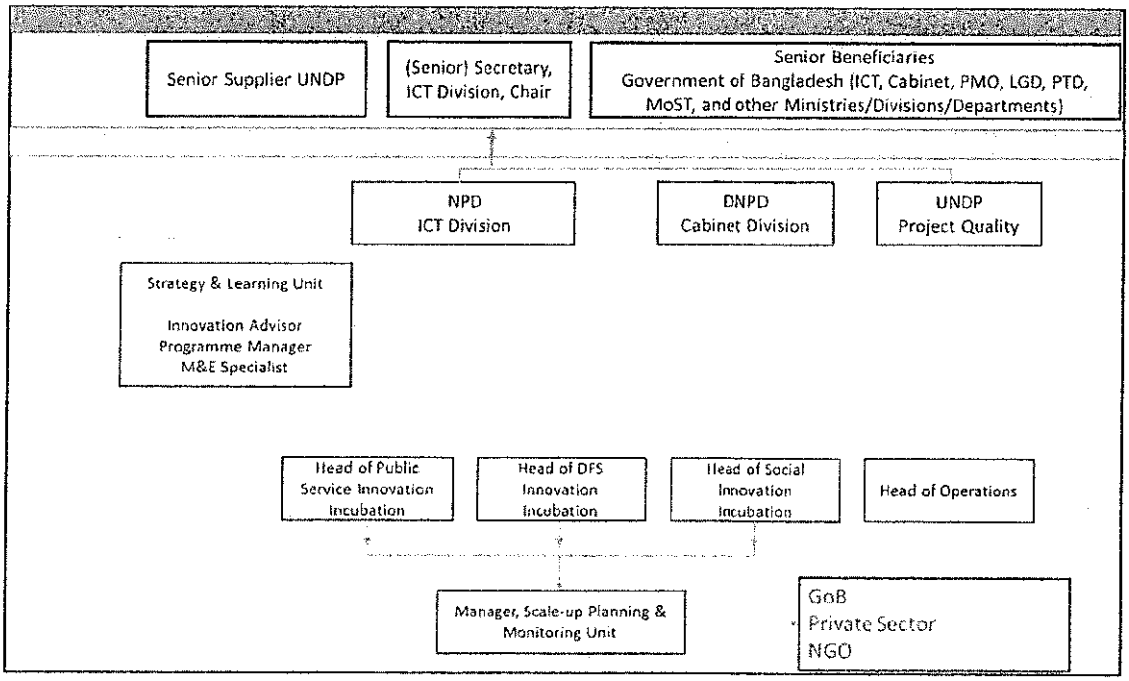
VII. GOVERNANCE AND MANAGEMENT ARRANGEMENTS

The programme will be managed in a manner consistent with the National Implementation Modality (NIM)/NEX or any future agreement between UNDP and the Government of Bangladesh.

Oversight of the programme will be provided by a Project Board (PB) responsible for making, by consensus, management decisions for the programme when guidance is required by the Innovation Advisor, including approval of Annual Work Plans and revisions. The PB will meet at least twice a year and its decisions should ensure best value for money, fairness, integrity, transparency and effective international competition. The PB will be chaired by the Secretary, ICT division and the PB will include members from Prime Minister's Office, Ministry of Public Administration, Local Government Division, Post and Telecommunications Division, Ministry of Science and Technology, Secondary and Higher Education Division. Technical and Madrasah Education Division, Ministry of Commerce, Ministry of Industry, Finance Division, Socio-economic Infrastructure Division, Bangladesh Bank, IMED, ERD, Bangladesh Computer Council, Department of ICT, UNDP Bangladesh & Co-funding development partners. The programme will also include leading private sector associations such as FBCCI, BASIS, e-CAB etc.

The PB comprises of the following three roles:

1. Executive: (Senior) Secretary, ICT Division as Chairperson, National Project Director as Member Secretary, Deputy National Project Director;
2. Senior Supplier: UNDP;
3. Senior Beneficiaries: Focal persons from the relevant ministries.



The National Project Director (NPD) will be responsible for guiding the overall management of the programme activities, ensuring that they are consistent with the agreed Annual Work Plan. Such guidance from the NPD will ensure that the programme's results are consistent with national priorities, fully integrated into the national system, and are sustainable.

The DNPD, with delegated authority, will have complementary and mutually supporting roles associated with overseeing planning and implementation. The NPD may assign DNPD with one or more project activities to supervise on his behalf.

The Innovation Advisor (IA) will lead the Strategy and Learning Unit (SLU) and will guide the Programme Manager (PM). The PM, working with the Operations Manager, is responsible for ensuring that the programme is managed in an effective and accountable manner, complying with UNDP reporting and audit arrangements. The IA will provide technical inputs and guidance to the leaders of the programme components. Annual reviews, work plans, and budgets will be prepared by the project team and submitted to UNDP by the NPD. UNDP will share narrative and financial reports with co-funding development partners.

VIII. LEGAL CONTEXT AND RISK MANAGEMENT

1. Legal Context:
   - ☐ √Country has signed the Standard Basic Assistance Agreement (SBAA)
   - ☐ Country has not signed the Standard Basic Assistance Agreement (SBAA)
   - ☐ Regional or Global project

2. Implementing Partner:
   - ☐ √Government Entity (NIM/NEX)
   - ☐ UNDP (DIM)
   - ☐ CSO/NGO/IGO
   - ☐ UN Agency (other than UNDP)
   - ☐ Global and regional projects

IX. ANNEXES

Annex I: Project Quality Assurance Report

PROJECT QA ASSESSMENT: DESIGN AND APPRAISAL

OVERALL PROJECT

EXEMPLARY (5) ◎◎◎◎◎	HIGHLY SATISFACTORY (4) ◎◎◎◎○	SATISFACTORY (3) ◎◎◎○○	NEEDS IMPROVEMENT (2) ◎◎○○○	INADEQUATE (1) ◎○○○○
At least four criteria are rated Exemplary, and all criteria are rated High or Exemplary.	All criteria are rated Satisfactory or higher, and at least four criteria are rated High or Exemplary.	At least six criteria are rated Satisfactory or higher, and only one may be rated Needs Improvement. The SES criterion must be rated Satisfactory or above.	At least three criteria are rated Satisfactory or higher, and only four criteria may be rated Needs Improvement.	One or more criteria are rated Inadequate, or five or more criteria are rated Needs Improvement.

DECISION

- APPROVE – the project is of sufficient quality to continue as planned. Any management actions must be addressed in a timely manner.
- APPROVE WITH QUALIFICATIONS – the project has issues that must be addressed before the project document can be approved. Any management actions must be addressed in a timely manner.
- DISAPPROVE – the project has significant issues that should prevent the project from being approved as drafted.

RATING CRITERIA

STRATEGIC

1. Does the project's Theory of Change specify how it will contribute to higher level change? (Select the option from 1-3 that best reflects the project): • 3: The project has a theory of change with explicit assumptions on how the project will contribute to higher level change as specified in the programme's theory of change, backed by credible evidence of what works effectively in this context. The project document clearly describes why the project's strategy is the best approach at this point in time. • 2: The project has a theory of change related to the programme's theory of change. It has explicit assumptions that explain how the project intends to contribute to higher level change and why the project strategy is the best approach at this point in time, but is backed by limited evidence. • 1: The project does not have a theory of change, but the project document may describe in generic terms how the project will contribute to development results, without specifying the key assumptions. It does not make an explicit link to the programme's theory of change. The project document does not clearly specify why the project's strategy is the best approach at this point in time. *Note: Management Action or strong management justification must be given for a score of 1	3 2 1	Evidence
2. Is the project aligned with the thematic focus of the UNDP Strategic Plan? (select the option from 1-3 that best reflects the project): • 3: The project responds to one of the three areas of development work[5] as specified in the Strategic Plan; it addresses at least one of the proposed new and emerging areas[6]; an issues-based analysis has been incorporated	3 2 1	

[5] 1. Sustainable development pathways; 2. Inclusive and effective democratic governance; 3. Resilience building

6 sustainable production technologies, access to modern energy services and energy efficiency, natural resources management, extractive industries, urbanization, citizen security, social protection, and risk management for resilience

into the project design; and the project's RRF includes all the relevant SP output indicators. *(all must be true to select this option)* • 2: The project responds to one of the three areas of development work[1] as specified in the Strategic Plan. The project's RRF includes at least one SP output indicator, if relevant. *(both must be true to select this option)* • 1: While the project may respond to one of the three areas of development work[1] as specified in the Strategic Plan, it is based on a sectoral approach without addressing the complexity of the development issue. None of the relevant SP indicators are included in the RRF. This answer is also selected if the project does not respond to any of the three areas of development work in the Strategic Plan.	**Evidence**
RELEVANT	
3. Does the project have strategies to effectively identify, engage and ensure the meaningful participation of targeted groups/geographic areas with a priority focus on the excluded and marginalized? (select the option from 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: The target groups/geographic areas are appropriately specified, prioritising the excluded and/or marginalised. The project has an explicit strategy to identify, engage and ensure the meaningful participation of specified target groups/geographic areas throughout the project. Beneficiaries will be identified through a rigorous process based on evidence (if applicable.) The project plans to solicit feedback from targeted groups regularly through project monitoring. Representatives of the targeted group/geographic areas will contribute to project decision-making, such as being included in the project's governance mechanism (i.e., project board.) *(all must be true to select this option)* • 2: The target groups/geographic areas are appropriately specified, prioritising the excluded and/or marginalised, and are engaged in project design. The project document states clearly how beneficiaries will be identified, engaged and how meaningful participation will be ensured throughout the project. Collecting feedback from targeted groups has been incorporated into the project's RRF/monitoring system, but representatives of the target group(s) may not be directly involved in the project's decision making. *(all must be true to select this option)* • 1: The target groups/geographic areas do not prioritize excluded and/or marginalised populations, or they may not be specified. The project does not have a written strategy to identify or engage or ensure the meaningful participation of the target groups/geographic areas throughout the project. *Note: Management Action must be taken for a score of 1	3 | 2 1 *Select (all) targeted groups: (drop-down)* **Evidence**
4. Have knowledge, good practices, and past lessons learned of UNDP and others informed the project design? (select the option from 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: Knowledge and lessons learned backed by credible evidence from evaluation, analysis and monitoring have been explicitly used, with appropriate referencing, to develop the project's theory of change and justify the approach used by the project over alternatives. • 2: The project design mentions knowledge and lessons learned backed by evidence/sources, which inform the project's theory of change but have not been used/are not sufficient to justify the approach selected over alternatives. • 1: There is only scant or no mention of knowledge and lessons learned informing the project design. Any references that are made are not backed by evidence. *Note: Management Action or strong management justification must be given for a score of 1	3 | 2 1 **Evidence**
5. Does the project use gender analysis in the project design and does the project respond to this gender analysis with concrete measures to address gender inequities and empower women? (select the option from 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: A participatory gender analysis on the project has been conducted. This analysis reflects on the different needs, roles and access to/control over resources of women and men, and it is fully integrated into the project document. The project establishes concrete priorities to address gender inequalities in its strategy. The results framework includes outputs and activities that specifically respond to this gender analysis, with indicators that measure and monitor results contributing to gender equality. *(all must be true to select this option)* • 2: A gender analysis on the project has been conducted. This analysis reflects on the different needs, roles and access to/control over resources of women and men. Gender concerns are integrated in the development challenge and strategy sections of the project document. The results framework includes outputs and activities that specifically respond to this gender analysis, with indicators that measure and monitor results contributing to gender equality. *(all must be true to select this option)* • 1: The project design may or may not mention information and/or data on the differential impact of the project's development situation on gender relations, women and men, but the constraints have not been clearly identified and interventions have not been considered. *Note: Management Action or strong management justification must be given for a score of 1	3 | 2 1 **Evidence**
6. Does UNDP have a clear advantage to engage in the role envisioned by the project vis-à-vis national partners, other development partners, and other actors? (select from options 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: An analysis has been conducted on the role of other partners in the area where the project intends to work, and credible evidence supports the proposed engagement of UNDP and partners through the project. It is clear how results achieved by relevant partners will contribute to outcome level change complementing the project's intended results. If relevant, options for south-south and triangular cooperation have been considered, as appropriate. *(all must be true to select this option)* • 2: Some analysis has been conducted on the role of other partners where the project intends to work, and relatively limited evidence supports the proposed engagement of and division of labour between UNDP and	3 | 2 1 **Evidence**

partners through the project. Options for south-south and triangular cooperation may not have not been fully developed during project design, even if relevant opportunities have been identified. • 1: No clear analysis has been conducted on the role of other partners in the area that the project intends to work, and relatively limited evidence supports the proposed engagement of UNDP and partners through the project. There is risk that the project overlaps and/or does not coordinate with partners' interventions in this area. Options for south-south and triangular cooperation have not been considered, despite its potential relevance. *Note: Management Action or strong management justification must be given for a score of 1	
SOCIAL & ENVIRONMENTAL STANDARDS	
7. Does the project seek to further the realization of human rights using a human rights based approach? (select from options 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: Credible evidence that the project aims to further the realization of human rights, specifically upholding the relevant international and national laws and standards in the area of the project. Any potential adverse impacts on enjoyment of human rights were rigorously assessed and identified with appropriate mitigation and management measures incorporated into project design and budget. *(all must be true to select this option)* • 2: Some evidence that the project aims to further the realization of human rights. Potential adverse impacts on enjoyment of human rights were assessed and identified and appropriate mitigation and management measures incorporated into the project design and budget. • 1: No evidence that the project aims to further the realization of human rights. Limited or no evidence that potential adverse impacts on enjoyment of human rights were considered. *Note: Management action or strong management justification must be given for a score of 1	3 | 2 1 Evidence
8. Did the project consider potential environmental opportunities and adverse impacts, applying a precautionary approach? (select from options 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: Credible evidence that opportunities to enhance environmental sustainability and integrate poverty-environment linkages were fully considered and integrated in project strategy and design. Credible evidence that potential adverse environmental impacts have been identified and rigorously assessed with appropriate management and mitigation measures incorporated into project design and budget. *(all must be true to select this option)*. • 2: No evidence that opportunities to strengthen environmental sustainability and poverty-environment linkages were considered. Credible evidence that potential adverse environmental impacts have been assessed, if relevant, and appropriate management and mitigation measures incorporated into project design and budget. • 1: No evidence that opportunities to strengthen environmental sustainability and poverty-environment linkages were considered. Limited or no evidence that potential adverse environmental impacts were adequately considered. *Note: Management action or strong management justification must be given for a score of 1	3 | 2 1 Evidence
9. If the project is worth $500,000 or more, has the Social and Environmental Screening Procedure (SESP) been conducted to identify potential social and environmental impacts and risks? Select N/A only if the project is worth less than $500,000. [if yes, upload the completed checklist]	Yes | No N/A
MANAGEMENT & MONITORING	
10. Does the project have a strong results framework? (select from options 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: The project's selection of outputs and activities are at an appropriate level and relate in a clear way to the project's theory of change. Outputs are accompanied by SMART, results-oriented indicators that measure all of the key expected changes identified in the theory of change, each with credible data sources, and populated baselines and targets, including gender sensitive, sex-disaggregated indicators where appropriate. *(all must be true to select this option)* • 2: The project's selection of outputs and activities are at an appropriate level, but may not cover all aspects of the project's theory of change. Outputs are accompanied by SMART, results-oriented indicators, but baselines, targets and data sources may not yet be fully specified. Some use of gender sensitive, sex-disaggregated indicators, as appropriate. *(all must be true to select this option)* • 1: The results framework does not meet all of the conditions specified in selection "2" above. This includes: the project's selection of outputs and activities are not at an appropriate level and do not relate in a clear way to the project's theory of change; outputs are not accompanied by SMART, results-oriented indicators that measure the expected change, and have not been populated with baselines and targets; data sources are not specified, and/or no gender sensitive, sex-disaggregation of indicators. *Note: Management Action or strong management justification must be given for a score of 1	3 | 2 1 Evidence
11. Is there a comprehensive and costed M&E plan with specified data collection sources and methods to support evidence-based management, monitoring and evaluation of the project?	Yes (3) | No (1)
12. Is the project's governance mechanism clearly defined in the project document, including planned composition of the project board? (select from options 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: The project's governance mechanism is fully defined in the project composition. Individuals have been specified for each position in the governance mechanism (especially all members of the project board.) Project Board members have agreed on their roles and responsibilities as specified in the terms of reference. The ToR of the project board has been attached to the project document. *(all must be true to select this option).*	3 | 2 1 Evidence

◦ 2: The project's governance mechanism is defined in the project document; specific institutions are noted as holding key governance roles, but individuals may not have been specified yet. The prodoc lists the most important responsibilities of the project board, project director/manager and quality assurance roles. *(all must be true to select this option)* ◦ 1: The project's governance mechanism is loosely defined in the project document, only mentioning key roles that will need to be filled at a later date. No information on the responsibilities of key positions in the governance mechanism is provided. *Note: Management Action or strong management justification must be given for a score of 1		
13. Have the project risks been identified with clear plans stated to manage and mitigate each risks? (select from options 1-3 that best reflects this project): ◦ 3: Project risks fully described in the project risk log, based on comprehensive analysis which references key assumptions made in the project's theory of change. Clear and complete plan in place to manage and mitigate each risk. *(both must be true to select this option)* ◦ 2: Project risks identified in the initial project risk log with mitigation measures identified for each risk. ◦ 1: Some risks may be identified in the initial project risk log, but no clear risk mitigation measures identified. This option is also selected if risks are not clearly identified and no initial risk log is included with the project document. *Note: Management Action must be taken for a score of 1	3 | 2 1 **Evidence**	
EFFICIENT		
14. Have specific measures for ensuring cost-efficient use of resources been explicitly mentioned as part of the project design? This can include: i) using the theory of change analysis to explore different options of achieving the maximum results with the resources available; ii) using a portfolio management approach to improve cost effectiveness through synergies with other interventions; iii) through joint operations (e.g., monitoring or procurement) with other partners.	Yes (3)	No (1)
15. Are explicit plans in place to ensure the project links up with other relevant on-going projects and initiatives, whether led by UNDP, national or other partners, to achieve more efficient results (including, for example, through sharing resources or coordinating delivery?)	Yes (3)	No (1)
16. Is the budget justified and supported with valid estimates?	Yes (3)	No (1)
17. Is the Country Office fully recovering its costs involved with project implementation?	Yes (3)	No (1)
EFFECTIVE		
18. Is the chosen implementation modality most appropriate? (select from options 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: The required implementing partner assessments (capacity assessment, HACT micro assessment) have been conducted, and there is evidence that options for implementation modalities have been thoroughly considered. There is a strong justification for choosing the selected modality, based on the development context. *(both must be true to select this option)* • 2: The required implementing partner assessments (capacity assessment, HACT micro assessment) have been conducted and the implementation modality chosen is consistent with the results of the assessments. • 1: The required assessments have not been conducted, but there may be evidence that options for implementation modalities have been considered. *Note: Management Action or strong management justification must be given for a score of 1	3 | 2 1 **Evidence**	
19. Have targeted groups, prioritizing marginalized and excluded populations that will be affected by the project, been engaged in the design of the project in a way that addresses any underlying causes of exclusion and discrimination? • 3: Credible evidence that all targeted groups, prioritising marginalized and excluded populations that will be involved in or affected by the project, have been actively engaged in the design of the project. Their views, rights and any constraints have been analysed and incorporated into the root cause analysis of the theory of change which seeks to address any underlying causes of exclusion and discrimination and the selection of project interventions. • 2: Some evidence that key targeted groups, prioritising marginalized and excluded populations that will be involved in the project, have been engaged in the design of the project. Some evidence that their views, rights and any constraints have been analysed and incorporated into the root cause analysis of the theory of change and the selection of project interventions. • 1: No evidence of engagement with marginalized and excluded populations that will be involved in the project during project design. No evidence that the views, rights and constraints of populations have been incorporated into the project.	3 | 2 1 **Evidence**	
20. Does the project have explicit plans for evaluation or other lesson learning, timed to inform course corrections if needed during project implementation?	Yes (3)	No (1)
21. The gender marker for all project outputs are scored at GEN2 or GEN3, indicating that gender has been fully mainstreamed into all project outputs at a minimum. *Note: Management Action or strong management justification must be given for a score of "no"	Yes (3) | No (1) **Evidence**	

22. Is there a realistic multi-year work plan and budget to ensure outputs are delivered on time and within allotted resources? (select from options 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: The project has a realistic work plan & budget covering the duration of the project *at the activity* level to ensure outputs are delivered on time and within the allotted resources. • 2: The project has a work plan & budget covering the duration of the project at the output level. • 1: The project does not yet have a work plan & budget covering the duration of the project.	3 | 2 1 **Evidence**	
SUSTAINABILITY & NATIONAL OWNERSHIP		
23. Have national partners led, or proactively engaged in, the design of the project? (select from options 1-3 that best reflects this project): • 3: National partners have full ownership of the project and led the process of the development of the project jointly with UNDP. • 2: The project has been developed by UNDP in close consultation with national partners. • 1: The project has been developed by UNDP with limited or no engagement with national partners.	3 | 2 1 **Evidence**	
24. Are key institutions and systems identified, and is there a strategy for strengthening specific/ comprehensive capacities based on capacity assessments conducted? (select from options 0-4 that best reflects this project): • 4: The project has a comprehensive strategy for strengthening specific capacities of national institutions based on a systematic and detailed capacity assessment that has been completed. • 3: A capacity assessment has been completed. The project document has identified activities that will be undertaken to strengthen capacity of national institutions, but these activities are not part of a comprehensive strategy. • 2: A capacity assessment is planned after the start of the project. There are plans to develop a strategy to strengthen specific capacities of national institutions based on the results of the capacity assessment. • 1: There is mention in the project document of capacities of national institutions to be strengthened through the project, but no capacity assessments or specific strategy development are planned. • 0: Capacity assessments have not been carried out and are not foreseen. There is no strategy for strengthening specific capacities of national institutions.	4 | 3 2 | 1 0 **Evidence**	
25. Is there is a clear strategy embedded in the project specifying how the project will use national systems (i.e., procurement, monitoring, evaluations, etc.,) to the extent possible?	Yes (3)	No (1)
26. Is there a clear transition arrangement/ phase-out plan developed with key stakeholders in order to sustain or scale up results (including resource mobilisation strategy)?	Yes (3)	No (1)

1. **Social and Environmental Screening Template** [English][French][Spanish], including additional Social and Environmental Assessments or Management Plans as relevant. *(NOTE: The SES Screening is not required for projects in which UNDP is Administrative Agent only and/or projects comprised solely of reports, coordination of events, trainings, workshops, meetings, conferences, preparation of communication materials, strengthening capacities of partners to participate in international negotiations and conferences, partnership coordination and management of networks, or global/regional projects with no country level activities).*

Annex II: Social and Environmental Screening Report

Project Information

Project Information	
1. Project Title	Aspire to Innovate (a2i) Programme
2. Project Number	???
3. Location (Global/Region/Country)	Bangladesh

Part A. Integrating Overarching Principles to Strengthen Social and Environmental Sustainability

QUESTION 1: How Does the Project Integrate the Overarching Principles in order to Strengthen Social and Environmental Sustainability?
Briefly describe in the space below how the Project mainstreams the human-rights based approach
The project has been designed to work alongside the Government of Bangladesh, various private sector entities and the citizens of the country to enhance public service access and availability while increasing transparency and accountability in all of government. Through its various interventions project will ensure full and effective stakeholder engagement, including through various mechanism of feedbacks from people involved and affected by the project. Through the project's policy framework initiatives, it will work toward improving decent work for all, particularly for vulnerable women, youth and marginalized populations. The project also plans to empower vulnerable women, youth and marginalized populations through providing universal access to basic services and financial and non-financial assets to build productive capacities and so they can benefit from sustainable livelihoods and jobs. In addition, project will work toward empowering social innovators and entrepreneurs who are working toward challenging and improving social and environmental issues in support of social progress.
Briefly describe in the space below how the Project is likely to improve gender equality and women's empowerment
The project will work toward ensuring women, especially those living in rural areas have full and easy access to public services. Special attention will be given toward expanding women entrepreneurship and gender sensitive service delivery by increasing capacity of women through providing training on business and marketing skills, so they can achieve high level of success as Digital Centre Entrepreneurs and '333' call operators. As part of new education initiatives, focus will be given to ensure gender sensitivity on education to promote positive stereotypes. More women especially in rural areas will be encourage to take on entrepreneurship in consequence of initiatives like DFS, which will allow women entrepreneurs to pursue forward integration in businesses easily and by pass middlemen to reach end-consumers directly. In addition, women empowerment and gender equality will be in forefront of all awareness and sensitization campaigns the project will introduce for its various initiatives. When it comes to tracking project progress all appropriate data will be incorporate age and sex-disaggregate data and gender statistics to ensure tracking of fair representation is taking place.
Briefly describe in the space below how the Project mainstreams environmental sustainability
This project will take steps to adopt innovative and accountable actions by its education initiatives, social media campaigns and through supporting social innovators and entrepreneurs, who are working toward addressing emerging challenges in areas such as climate change.

Part B. Identifying and Managing Social and Environmental Risks

QUESTION 2: What are the Potential Social and Environmental Risks? *Note: Describe briefly potential social and environmental risks identified in Attachment 1 – Risk Screening Checklist (based on any "Yes" responses). If no risks have been identified in Attachment 1 then note "No Risks Identified" and skip to Question 4 and Select "Low Risk". Questions 5 and 6 not required for Low Risk Projects.*	**QUESTION 3: What is the level of significance of the potential social and environmental risks?** *Note: Respond to Questions 4 and 5 below before proceeding to Question 6*			**QUESTION 6: What social and environmental assessment and management measures have been conducted and/or are required to address potential risks (for Risks with Moderate and High Significance)?**
Risk Description	***Impact and Probability (1-5)***	***Significance (Low, Moderate, High)***	***Comments***	***Description of assessment and management measures as reflected in the Project design. If ESIA or SESA is required note that the assessment should consider all potential impacts and risks.***
No risk identified	I = P =			Not applicable.
	I = P =			
	I = P =			
	I = P =			
			Not applicable.	

QUESTION 4: What is the overall Project risk categorization?

Select one (see SESP for guidance)		Comments
Low Risk	☑	
Moderate Risk	☐	
High Risk	☐	

QUESTION 5: Based on the identified risks and risk categorization, what requirements of the SES are relevant?

Check all that apply		Comments
Principle 1: Human Rights	☐	
Principle 2: Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment	☐	
1. Biodiversity Conservation and Natural Resource Management	☐	
2. Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation	☐	
3. Community Health, Safety and Working Conditions	☐	
4. Cultural Heritage	☐	
5. Displacement and Resettlement	☐	
6. Indigenous Peoples	☐	
7. Pollution Prevention and Resource Efficiency	☐	

Final Sign Off

Signature	*Date*	*Description*
QA Assessor		UNDP staff member responsible for the Project, typically a UNDP Programme Officer. Final signature confirms they have "checked" to ensure that the SESP is adequately conducted.
QA Approver		UNDP senior manager, typically the Deputy Resident Representative (DRR), or Resident Representative (RR). The QA Approver cannot also be the QA Assessor. Final signature confirms they have "cleared" the SESP prior to submittal to the PAC.
PAC Chair		UNDP chair of the PAC. In some cases PAC Chair may also be the QA Approver. Final signature confirms that the SESP was considered as part of the project appraisal and considered in recommendations of the PAC.

SESP Attachment 1. Social and Environmental Risk Screening Checklist

Checklist Potential Social and Environmental Risks		
Principles 1: Human Rights		**Answer (Yes/No)**
1.	Could the Project lead to adverse impacts on enjoyment of the human rights (civil, political, economic, social or cultural) of the affected population and particularly of marginalized groups?	No
2.	Is there a likelihood that the Project would have inequitable or discriminatory adverse impacts on affected populations, particularly people living in poverty or marginalized or excluded individuals or groups?[7]	Yes (if traditionally excluded/marginilized group are not included)
3.	Could the Project potentially restrict availability, quality of and access to resources or basic services, in particular to marginalized individuals or groups?	Yes
4.	Is there a likelihood that the Project would exclude any potentially affected stakeholders, in particular marginalized groups, from fully participating in decisions that may affect them?	Yes
5.	Is there a risk that duty-bearers do not have the capacity to meet their obligations in the Project?	yes
6.	Is there a risk that rights-holders do not have the capacity to claim their rights?	yes
7.	Have local communities or individuals, given the opportunity, raised human rights concerns regarding the Project during the stakeholder engagement process?	No
8.	Is there a risk that the Project would exacerbate conflicts among and/or the risk of violence to project-affected communities and individuals?	No
Principle 2: Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment		
1.	Is there a likelihood that the proposed Project would have adverse impacts on gender equality and/or the situation of women and girls?	No
2.	Would the Project potentially reproduce discriminations against women based on gender, especially regarding participation in design and implementation or access to opportunities and benefits?	yes
3.	Have women's groups/leaders raised gender equality concerns regarding the Project during the stakeholder engagement process and has this been included in the overall Project proposal and in the risk assessment?	No
4.	Would the Project potentially limit women's ability to use, develop and protect natural resources, taking into account different roles and positions of women and men in accessing environmental goods and services? *For example, activities that could lead to natural resources degradation or depletion in communities who depend on these resources for their livelihoods and well being*	No
Principle 3: Environmental Sustainability: Screening questions regarding environmental risks are encompassed by the specific Standard-related questions below		
Standard 1: Biodiversity Conservation and Sustainable Natural Resource Management		
1.1	Would the Project potentially cause adverse impacts to habitats (e.g. modified, natural, and critical habitats) and/or ecosystems and ecosystem services? *For example, through habitat loss, conversion or degradation, fragmentation, hydrological changes*	No
1.2	Are any Project activities proposed within or adjacent to critical habitats and/or environmentally sensitive areas, including legally protected areas (e.g. nature reserve, national park), areas proposed for protection, or recognized as such by authoritative sources and/or indigenous peoples or local communities?	No
1.3	Does the Project involve changes to the use of lands and resources that may have adverse impacts on habitats, ecosystems, and/or livelihoods? (Note: if restrictions and/or limitations of access to lands would apply, refer to Standard 5)	No
1.4	Would Project activities pose risks to endangered species?	No
1.5	Would the Project pose a risk of introducing invasive alien species?	No
1.6	Does the Project involve harvesting of natural forests, plantation development, or reforestation?	No

[7] Prohibited grounds of discrimination include race, ethnicity, gender, age, language, disability, sexual orientation, religion, political or other opinion, national or social or geographical origin, property, birth or other status including as an indigenous person or as a member of a minority. References to "women and men" or similar is understood to include women and men, boys and girls, and other groups discriminated against based on their gender identities, such as transgender people and transsexuals.

1.7	Does the Project involve the production and/or harvesting of fish populations or other aquatic species?	No
1.8	Does the Project involve significant extraction, diversion or containment of surface or ground water? *For example, construction of dams, reservoirs, river basin developments, groundwater extraction*	No
1.9	Does the Project involve utilization of genetic resources? (e.g. collection and/or harvesting, commercial development)	No
1.10	Would the Project generate potential adverse transboundary or global environmental concerns?	No
1.11	Would the Project result in secondary or consequential development activities which could lead to adverse social and environmental effects, or would it generate cumulative impacts with other known existing or planned activities in the area? *For example, a new road through forested lands will generate direct environmental and social impacts (e.g. felling of trees, earthworks, potential relocation of inhabitants). The new road may also facilitate encroachment on lands by illegal settlers or generate unplanned commercial development along the route, potentially in sensitive areas. These are indirect, secondary, or induced impacts that need to be considered. Also, if similar developments in the same forested area are planned, then cumulative impacts of multiple activities (even if not part of the same Project) need to be considered.*	No
Standard 2: Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation		
2.1	Will the proposed Project result in significant[8] greenhouse gas emissions or may exacerbate climate change?	No
2.2	Would the potential outcomes of the Project be sensitive or vulnerable to potential impacts of climate change?	No
2.3	Is the proposed Project likely to directly or indirectly increase social and environmental vulnerability to climate change now or in the future (also known as maladaptive practices)? *For example, changes to land use planning may encourage further development of floodplains, potentially increasing the population's vulnerability to climate change, specifically flooding*	No
Standard 3: Community Health, Safety and Working Conditions		
3.1	Would elements of Project construction, operation, or decommissioning pose potential safety risks to local communities?	No
3.2	Would the Project pose potential risks to community health and safety due to the transport, storage, and use and/or disposal of hazardous or dangerous materials (e.g. explosives, fuel and other chemicals during construction and operation)?	No
3.3	Does the Project involve large-scale infrastructure development (e.g. dams, roads, buildings)?	No
3.4	Would failure of structural elements of the Project pose risks to communities? (e.g. collapse of buildings or infrastructure)	No
3.5	Would the proposed Project be susceptible to or lead to increased vulnerability to earthquakes, subsidence, landslides, erosion, flooding or extreme climatic conditions?	No
3.6	Would the Project result in potential increased health risks (e.g. from water-borne or other vector-borne diseases or communicable infections such as HIV/AIDS)?	No
3.7	Does the Project pose potential risks and vulnerabilities related to occupational health and safety due to physical, chemical, biological, and radiological hazards during Project construction, operation, or decommissioning?	No
3.8	Does the Project involve support for employment or livelihoods that may fail to comply with national and international labor standards (i.e. principles and standards of ILO fundamental conventions)?	No
3.9	Does the Project engage security personnel that may pose a potential risk to health and safety of communities and/or individuals (e.g. due to a lack of adequate training or accountability)?	No
Standard 4: Cultural Heritage		
4.1	Will the proposed Project result in interventions that would potentially adversely impact sites, structures, or objects with historical, cultural, artistic, traditional or religious values or intangible forms of culture (e.g. knowledge, innovations, practices)? (Note: Projects intended to protect and conserve Cultural Heritage may also have inadvertent adverse impacts)	No
4.2	Does the Project propose utilizing tangible and/or intangible forms of cultural heritage for commercial or other purposes?	No
Standard 5: Displacement and Resettlement		
5.1	Would the Project potentially involve temporary or permanent and full or partial physical displacement?	No
5.2	Would the Project possibly result in economic displacement (e.g. loss of assets or access to resources due to land acquisition or access restrictions – even in the absence of physical relocation)?	No

[8] In regards to CO_2, 'significant emissions' corresponds generally to more than 25,000 tons per year (from both direct and indirect sources). [The Guidance Note on Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation provides additional information on GHG emissions.]

5.3	Is there a risk that the Project would lead to forced evictions?[9]	No
5.4	Would the proposed Project possibly affect land tenure arrangements and/or community based property rights/customary rights to land, territories and/or resources?	
Standard 6: Indigenous Peoples		
6.1	Are indigenous peoples present in the Project area (including Project area of influence)?	No
6.2	Is it likely that the Project or portions of the Project will be located on lands and territories claimed by indigenous peoples?	No
6.3	Would the proposed Project potentially affect the human rights, lands, natural resources, territories, and traditional livelihoods of indigenous peoples (regardless of whether indigenous peoples possess the legal titles to such areas, whether the Project is located within or outside of the lands and territories inhabited by the affected peoples, or whether the indigenous peoples are recognized as indigenous peoples by the country in question)? *If the answer to the screening question 6.3 is "yes" the potential risk impacts are considered potentially severe and/or critical and the Project would be categorized as either Moderate or High Risk.*	No
6.4	Has there been an absence of culturally appropriate consultations carried out with the objective of achieving FPIC on matters that may affect the rights and interests, lands, resources, territories and traditional livelihoods of the indigenous peoples concerned?	No
6.5	Does the proposed Project involve the utilization and/or commercial development of natural resources on lands and territories claimed by indigenous peoples?	No
6.6	Is there a potential for forced eviction or the whole or partial physical or economic displacement of indigenous peoples, including through access restrictions to lands, territories, and resources?	No
6.7	Would the Project adversely affect the development priorities of indigenous peoples as defined by them?	No
6.8	Would the Project potentially affect the physical and cultural survival of indigenous peoples?	No
6.9	Would the Project potentially affect the Cultural Heritage of indigenous peoples, including through the commercialization or use of their traditional knowledge and practices?	No
Standard 7: Pollution Prevention and Resource Efficiency		
7.1	Would the Project potentially result in the release of pollutants to the environment due to routine or non-routine circumstances with the potential for adverse local, regional, and/or transboundary impacts?	No
7.2	Would the proposed Project potentially result in the generation of waste (both hazardous and non-hazardous)?	No
7.3	Will the proposed Project potentially involve the manufacture, trade, release, and/or use of hazardous chemicals and/or materials? Does the Project propose use of chemicals or materials subject to international bans or phase-outs? *For example, DDT, PCBs and other chemicals listed in international conventions such as the Stockholm Conventions on Persistent Organic Pollutants or the Montreal Protocol*	No
7.4	Will the proposed Project involve the application of pesticides that may have a negative effect on the environment or human health?	No
7.5	Does the Project include activities that require significant consumption of raw materials, energy, and/or water?	No

[9] Forced evictions include acts and/or omissions involving the coerced or involuntary displacement of individuals, groups, or communities from homes and/or lands and common property resources that were occupied or depended upon, thus eliminating the ability of an individual, group, or community to reside or work in a particular dwelling, residence, or location without the provision of, and access to, appropriate forms of legal or other protections.

Annex III: Risk Analysis

#	Description	Date Identified	Type	Impact & Probability 1= Low 5= High	Countermeasures / Management response	Owner	Submitted, updated by	Last Update	Status
1-	Preventing corruption and reducing fiduciary risks require strengthening quality control mechanisms for cash transfers, undertaking assessments of the financial management capacities of implementing partners, and implementing spot checks and closer monitoring, including audits and evaluations.	March 2019	Operational	Impact- 4 Probability-3	Building on lessons from the previous phases, UNDP Country Programme oversight will play a key role in monitoring and managing fiduciary risks	ICT Division and UNDP			
2-	Large scale systems implementation may be delayed due to the lack of server resources in National Data Center.	March 2019	Infrastructure	Impact- 2 Probability-3	The programme will closely work with Bangladesh Computer Council to address the issue.	ICT Division and UNDP			
3-	Resource mobilization is an emerging challenge as Bangladesh graduates from least developed country status	March 2019	Financial	Impact- 5 Probability-3	The programme will widen its resource base, prioritizing government support arrangements and new partnerships with the private sector and emerging development partners such as the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation	ICT Division and UNDP			
4-	If e-Services grow in uncoordinated manner, may create duplication, waste and lack of interoperability	March 2019	Operational	Impact=3 Probability =3	The programme has arranged capacity development and Awareness raising programmes so that the service providers can manage standard interoperable software modules and reuse existing modules. Ensured coordination with the other relevant agencies	ICT Division and UNDP			
5-	Broadband connectivity not reaching rural areas severely	March 2019	Political, Operational	Impact=5 Probability =3	The project will maintain continuous coordination with the relevant	ICT Division and UNDP			

#	Description	Date Identified	Type	Impact & Probability 1= Low 5= High	Countermeasures / Management response	Owner	Submitted, updated by	Last Update	Status
	impacting programme's ability to deliver more sophisticated services				agencies to facilitate the improvement of connectivity				
6-	Frequent transfer and staff turnover, particularly in key positions	March 2019	Organizational	Impact=5 Probability =4	Devise a Knowledge Management initiatives in the government. Train and use 'desk officers' as part of the knowledge management plan. Instrumentalize incentives to retain talented staff and continually train and sensitize service providers and government officials.	ICT Division and UNDP			
7-	Lack of ownership to project initiatives at government level can affect sustainability, scale-up and replication	March 2019	Organizational, Financial, Operational	Impact=3 Probability =2	Initiatives to make necessary policy advocacy (office orders, circulars etc.) to develop ownership of the government.	ICT Division and UNDP			
8-	Scaling up of institutionalization may be delayed or may not be happened	March 2019	Operational	Impact=2 Probability =1	Continuous motivation, capacity development and monitoring are key factors	ICT Division and UNDP			

Annex IV Micro Assessment Report

Micro Assessment of Information and Communication Technology Division (ICT Division)

Commissioned by UNDP Office in Bangladesh
J. U. Ahmed & Co., Chartered Accountants
August 02, 2018

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1. Background, Scope and Methodology

Background

The micro assessment is part of the requirements under the Harmonized Approach to Cash Transfers (HACT) Framework. The HACT framework represents a common operational framework for UN agencies' transfer of cash to government and non-governmental implementing partners.

The micro assessment assesses the IP's control framework. It results in a risk rating (low, moderate, significant or high). The overall risk rating is used by the UN agencies, along with other available information (e.g. history of engagement with the agency and previous assurance results), to determine the type and frequency of assurance activities as per each agency's guideline and can be taken into consideration when selecting the appropriate cash transfer modality for an IP.

Scope

The micro assessment provides an overall assessment of the Implementing Partner's programme, financial and operations management policies, procedures, systems and internal controls. It includes:

- A review of the IP legal status, governance structures and financial viability; programme management, organizational structure and staffing, accounting policies and procedures, fixed assets and inventory, financial reporting and monitoring, and procurement;
- A focus on compliance with policies, procedures, regulations and institutional arrangements that are issued both by the Government and the Implementing Partner.

It takes into account results of any previous micro assessments conducted of the Implementing Partner.

Methodology

We performed the micro assessment on July 23, 2018 and July 26, 2018 at Information and Communication Technology Division (here-in-after referred to as ICT Division) at ICT Tower, Plot E-14/10, Sher-e-Bangla Nagar, Agargaon, Dhaka - 1207.

Through discussion with management, observation and walk-through tests of transactions, we have assessed the Implementing Partner's and the related internal control system with emphasis on:

- The effectiveness of the systems in providing the Implementing Partner's management with accurate and timely information for management of funds and assets in accordance with work plans and agreements with the United Nations agencies;
- The general effectiveness of the internal control system in protecting the assets and resources of the Implementing Partner.

We discussed the results of the micro assessment with applicable UN agency personnel and the IP prior to finalization of the report. The list of persons met and interviewed during the micro assessment is set out in Annex III.

2. Summary of Risk Assessment Results

ICT Division is a department of the Ministry of Post, Telecommunications and Information Technology of the Government of Bangladesh. It works for reliable and secure Information and Communication Technology (ICT) towards sustainable economic development. ICT Division has not yet implemented programmes financed by the UN agencies. It receives fund satisfactorily. It follows policies and procedures for project development, monitoring and evaluation. The organization structure of finance and programme management seems to be in line with scale of activities. ICT Division maintains manual accounting system. However, Cash Book was not shown at the time of assessment. Our assessment further reveals that a2i-II project maintains accounts using accounting software (ATLAS) for UNDP funds and in excel for GOB funds. Authorization control over expenditure is in place. Bank account is operated by the Deputy Secretary, Research and Scholarship Section, who is the Drawing and Disbursing Officer (DDO). Bank Reconciliation Statement is not prepared. Project budget is prepared with physical and financial targets. ICT Division generally follows policies and procedures issued by the Ministry of Finance, Ministry of Public Administration and Ministry of Post, Telecommunications and Information Technology. Internal control with regard to procurement appears to be satisfactory. Control over fixed assets was found to be satisfactory as physical verification of fixed assets was done pertaining to a2i-II project. However, control over inventories was not found to be satisfactory as physical verification of inventories was not done. Project financial statement is audited by the Foreign Aided Projects Audit Directorate (FAPAD) of the Government of Bangladesh. Financial report is prepared monthly/quarterly.

ICT Division follows the Public Procurement Act, 2006 and the Public Procurement Rules, 2008 to procure goods and services. Tender Opening Committee, Tender Evaluation Committee etc. is formed as per Public Procurement Rules (PPR). Tender Evaluation Committee analyses bids and recommends for purchase and the Project Director issues purchase order. Procurement system is not computerized. However, the procurement report is prepared.

The table below summarizes the results and main internal control gaps found during application of the micro assessment questionnaire (in Annex IV). Detailed findings and recommendations are set out in section 3 below.

Tested subject area	Risk assessment*	Brief justification for rating (main internal control gaps)
1. Implementing partner	Low	No internal control gap was identified.
2. Programme Management	Low	No independent evaluation of project was done.
3. Organizational structure and staffing	Low	No internal control gap was identified.
4. Accounting policies and procedures	Low	Bank Reconciliation Statement is not prepared. Invoices are not stamped 'Paid'.
5. Fixed Assets and Inventory	Significant	Store Keeper receives and issues inventories and keeps inventory records in ICT Division. Only motor vehicles are covered by insurance policy. Store items of a2i-II project were not found easily identifiable. Physical count of inventories was not done.
6. Financial Reporting and Monitoring	Moderate	ICT Division maintains financial management system manually.
7. Procurement	Low	Procurement system is not computerized.
Overall Risk Assessment	Low	

**High, Significant, Moderate, Low*

3. Detailed Internal Control Findings and Recommendations

No.	Description of Finding	Recommendation
1	Organizational Chart of a2i-II project is very concise. It does not depict the relationship between the different people, departments, and jobs clearly.	The organizational structure of a2i-II project should be reviewed and restructured immediately.
2	Bank Reconciliation Statement of ICT Division is not prepared.	Bank Reconciliation Statement of ICT Division should be prepared at the end of month.
3	Currently, store room of a2i-II project is rented in a flat at House no. 63/3/1, West Agargaon. It was not adequately secured. Store items were not found easily identifiable.	Store room should be placed in a secured place immediately. Store items should be arranged properly.

Annex I. IP and Programme Information

Implementing partner name:	Information and Communication Technology Division (ICT Division)
Implementing partner code or ID in UNICEF, UNDP, UNFPA records (as applicable)	Vendor Number not yet assigned.
Implementing partner contact details (contact name, email address and telephone number):	Jalal Uddin Ahmed Admin Specialist A2i-II Project e-mail: jalaluddin.ahmed@undp.org jalal.ahmed@a2i.gov.bd cell no. 01711332610 Website: www.ictd.gov.bd
Main programmes implemented with the applicable UN Agency/ies:	ICT Division has not yet implemented programmes with UNDP, UNICEF and UNFPA.
Key Official in charge of the UN Agency/ies' prorgamme(s):	Ms. Shaila Khan Assistant Country Director and Advisor e-mail: shaila.khan@undp.org
Programme location(s):	ICT Division, Ministry of Post, Telecommunications and Information Technology, Dhaka.
Location of records related to the UN Agency/ies' prorgramme(s):	At the ICT Division, Ministry of Post, Telecommunication and Information Technology, Sher-e-Bangla Nagar, Dhaka.
Currency of records maintained:	Bangladeshi Taka
Expenditures incurred/reported to UNICEF, UNDP and UNFPA (as applicable) during the most recent financial reporting period (in US$);	Not applicable - Programme implementation not yet started.
Cash transfer modality/ies used by the UN agency/ies to the IP	Direct Cash Transfer (DCT)
Intended start date of micro assessment:	July 23, 2018
Number of days to be spent for visit to IP:	2 days
Any special requests to be considered during the micro assessment:	None.

Annex II. Implementing Partner Organizational Chart

Organizational Chart of ICT

Government of the People's Republic of Bangladesh

Information and Communication Technology Division (ICTD)

Present Organogram

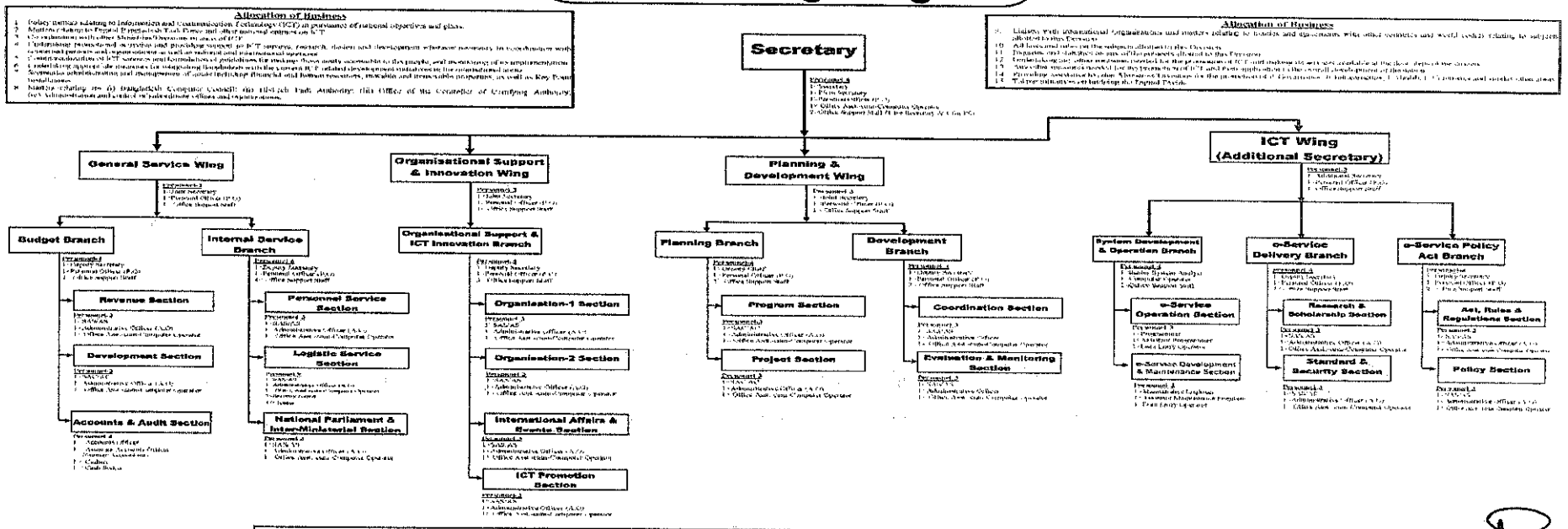
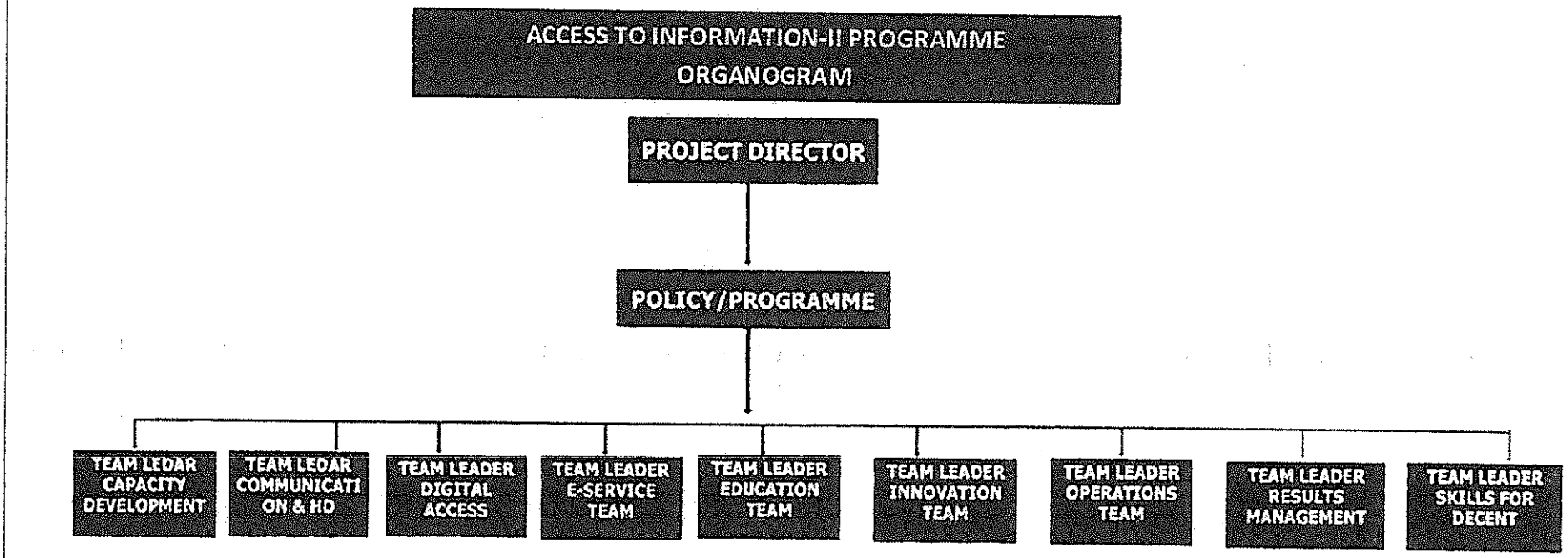


Table of Organisation and Equipment (TO&E)

1st-9th Grade Officials			10th - 20th Grade Officials			List of Office Equipments			List of Transports		
Sl.	Name of Post	Quantity	Sl.	Name of Post	Quantity	Sl.	Name of Office Equipments	Quantity	Sl.	Name of Transport	Quantity
1	Secretary	01	15	Administrative Officer (AAO)	17	1	Photocopier	05	1	Jeep	04
2	Additional Secretary	01	16	Personal Officer (PO)	12	2	Computer (with UPS)	61	2	Microbus	01
3	Joint Secretary	04	17	Assistant Accounts Officer (Former Assistant)	01	3	Printer	10	3	Motorcycle	01
4	Deputy Secretary	06	18	Computer Operator	11	4	Facsimile	02	Total		07
5	Deputy Chief	01	19	Cashier	01	5	Smart Board	01			
6	Senior Assistant Secretary (SAS)/Assistant Secretary (AS)	14	20	Office Assistant-cum-Computer Operator	10	6	Multimedia Projector	05			
7	Senior Assistant Chief (SAC)/Assistant Chief (AC)	03	21	Data Entry Operator	04	7	Network Printer	05			
8	PS to Secretary	01	22	Cash Sarkar	01	8	Scanner	01			
9	Senior System Analyst	01	23	Office Support Staff (Former MLSS)	24	9	Plotter/Scanner	04			
10	Programmer	01	24	Security Guard	02	10	Fax Machine	06			
11	Management Engineer	01	25	Cleaner	02	11	Photocopying Machine	01			
12	Accounts Officer	01				12	UPS	02			
13	Assistant Programmer	01				13	Server	04			
14	Assistant Maintenance Engineer	01				14	Digital Camera	01			
	Total	36		Total	84	15	Video Conferencing	01			
Grand Total (Manpower) = 36 + 84 = 120						16	Server	04			
						17	Switch	04			
						18	Router	04			
						19	Firewall	02			
						20	Storage (SAN)	02			
						21	Online UPS	04			
						22	Generator	02			
							Total	124			


ACCESS TO INFORMATION-II PROGRAMME
ORGANOGRAM
PROJECT DIRECTOR
POLICY/PROGRAMME
TEAM LEDAR CAPACITY DEVELOPMENT
TEAM LEDAR COMMUNICATI ON & HD
TEAM LEADER DIGITAL ACCESS
TEAM LEADER E-SERVICE TEAM
TEAM LEADER EDUCATION TEAM
TEAM LEADER INNOVATION TEAM
TEAM LEADER OPERATIONS TEAM
TEAM LEADER RESULTS MANAGEMENT
TEAM LEADER SKILLS FOR DECENT

Annex III. List of Persons Met

Name	Unit/Organization	Position
Aspia Aktar	ICT Division	Deputy Chief
Debottom Sanyal	ICT Division	Assistant Chief, Programme Section
Md. Zahidul Islam (Zahid)	ICT Division	Assistant Accounts Officer
Jalal Uddin Ahmed	A2i-II project	Administration Specialist
Mohammed Naser Miah	A2i-II project	Finance expert
Md. Jahangir Alam	A2i-II project	Consultant - Finance

Annex IV. Micro Assessment Questionnaire

Subject area *(key questions in **bold**)*	Yes	No	N/A	Risk Assessment	Risk points	Remarks/comments
1. Implementing Partner						
1.1 Is the IP legally registered? If so, is it in compliance with registration requirements? Please note the legal status and date of registration of the entity.			N/A	N/A	-	ICT Division is a department of the Ministry of Post, Telecommunications and Information Technology of the Government of Bangladesh. ICT Division is an executive branch of the Government of Bangladesh. It works for reliable and secure Information and Communication Technology (ICT) towards sustainable economic development. ICT Division supports attainment of overall socio economic development of the country by establishing universal access to ICT for all through research, development and successful utilization and digital management of ICT.
1.2 If the IP received United Nations resources in the past, were significant issues reported in managing the resources, including from previous assurance activities.			N/A	N/A	-	ICT Division has not yet implemented programmes with UNDP, UNICEF and UNFPA.
1.3 Does the IP have statutory reporting requirements? If so, are they in compliance with such requirements in the prior three fiscal years?			N/A	N/A	-	ICT Division does not have statutory reporting requirements as it is a division of Ministry of Post, Telecommunications and Information Technology of the Government of Bangladesh.
1.4 Does the governing body meet on a regular basis and perform oversight functions?			N/A	N/A	-	ICT Division does not have a governing body as it is a division of Ministry of Post, Telecommunications and Information Technology.
1.5 If any other offices/external entities participate in implementation, does the IP have policies and process to ensure appropriate oversight and monitoring of implementation?	Yes			Low	1	Oversight and monitoring of implementing entities is guided by the Allocation of Business among the different Ministries and Divisions (Rules of Business).

1.6 Does the IP show basic financial stability in-country (core resources; funding trend) ***Provide the amount of total assets, total liabilities, income and expenditure for the current and prior three fiscal years.***		-	N/A	N/A	-	Total question is not applicable to public sector financial management.
1.7 Can the IP easily receive funds? Have there been any major problems in the past in the receipt of funds, particularly where the funds flow from government ministries?	Yes			Low	1	ICT Division receives fund from development partners and GOB as per Revised Technical Assistance Project Proposal/Development Project Proposal (RTPP/DPP).
1.8 Does the IP have any pending legal actions against it or outstanding material/significant disputes with vendors/contractors? *If so, provide details and actions taken by the IP to resolve the legal action.*		No		Low	1	No such instance was reported at the time of assessment.
1.9 Does the IP have an anti-fraud and corruption policy?	Yes			Low	1	There is an Anti Corruption Commission (ACC) established under the Anti Corruption Commission Act, 2004, which is a statutory independent corruption prevention and corruption detective body of the state including all Govt. agencies. Besides, Money Laundering Prevention Act, 2012 and Whistleblower Protection Act, 2011 is in operation.
1.10 Has the IP advised employees, beneficiaries and other recipients to whom they should report if they suspect fraud, waste or misuse of agency resources or property? If so, does the IP have a policy against retaliation relating to such reporting?	Yes			Low	1	ACC has a well defined procedure for lodging a complaint. Moreover, policies against retaliation relating to reporting of fraud, waste and misuse of resources or property are stated in the Whistleblower Protection Act, 2011.
1.11 Does the IP have any key financial or operational risks that are not covered by this questionnaire? If so, please describe. *Examples: foreign exchange risk; cash receipts.*		No		Low	1	
Total number of questions in subject area:	**11**					
Total number of applicable questions in subject area:	**6**					
Total number of applicable key questions in subject area:	**1**					
Total number of risk points:	**6**					
Risk score	**1.0**					
Area risk rating	**Low**					

Subject area *(key questions in **bold**)*	Yes	No	N/A	Risk Assessment	Risk points	Remarks/comments
2. Programme Management						
2.1. Does the IP have and use sufficiently detailed written policies, procedures and other tools (e.g. project development checklist, work planning templates, work planning schedule) to develop programmes and plans?	Yes			Low	1	ICT Division follows policies and procedures and tools to develop programmes and plans.
2.2. Do work plans specify expected results and the activities to be carried out to achieve results, with a time frame and budget for the activities?	Yes			Low	1	The work plan outlines activity, indicators, deliverables and cost estimate, which is included in RTPP/DPP.
2.3 Does the IP identify the potential risks for programme delivery and mechanisms to mitigate them?	Yes			Low	1	ICT Division identifies potential risk to implement programmes and has mechanism to mitigate risk.
2.4 Does the IP have and use sufficiently detailed policies, procedures, guidelines and other tools (checklists, templates) for monitoring and evaluation?	Yes			Low	1	ICT Division has Monitoring Framework and Evaluation, Guidelines, Format etc. for monitoring and evaluation of projects.
2.5 Does the IP have M&E frameworks for its programmes, with indicators, baselines, and targets to monitor achievement of programme results?	Yes			Low	1	Monitoring Framework and Evaluation is included in the Revised Technical Assistance Project Proposal/Development Project Proposal (RTPP/DPP).
2.6 Does the IP carry out and document regular monitoring activities such as review meetings, on-site project visits, etc.	Yes			Low	1	Regular monitoring activities, such as, review meetings, on-site project visits etc. is included in RTPP/DPP.
2.7 Does the IP systematically collect, monitor and evaluate data on the achievement of project results?	Yes			Low	1	ICT Division collects, monitors and evaluates programmatic data on project outcome as per RTPP/DPP.
2.8 Is it evident that the IP followed up on independent evaluation recommendations?		No		High	4	No independent evaluation report was produced to us.
Total number of questions in subject area:	**8**					
Total number of applicable questions in subject area:	**8**					
Total number of applicable key questions in subject area:	**2**					
Total number of risk points:	**11**					
Risk score	**1.375**					
Area risk rating	**Low**					

Subject area *(key questions in **bold**)*	Yes	No	N/A	Risk Assessment	Risk points	Remarks/comments
3. Organizational Structure and Staffing						
3.1 Are the IP's recruitment, employment and personnel practices clearly defined and followed, and do they embrace transparency and competition?	Yes			Low	1	ICT Division follows policies issued by the Ministry of Public Administration (MOPA) and Public Procurement Rules, 2008 to employ personnel.
3.2 Does the IP have clearly defined job descriptions?	Yes			Low	1	Job descriptions are clearly defined and documented.
3.3 Is the organizational structure of the finance and programme management departments, and competency of staff, appropriate for the complexity of the IP and the scale of activities? Identify the key staff, including job titles, responsibilities, educational backgrounds and professional experience.	Yes			Low	1	The personnel of ICT Division are mainly from Bangladesh Civil Service (BCS) Cadres. The Project Director of a2i-II project is from BCS Administration Cadre. Mr. Anir Chowdhury is the Policy Advisor of a2i-II project. He has been working in a2i project since 2007 and holds a Bachelors in Computer Science from Brown University, Rhode Island, USA. Mr. Mohammed Naser Miah works as Finance Expert of a2i-II project. He completed his Graduation in Commerce from National University and Masters in Accounting from Jagannath University. He also completed Chartered Accountancy Course from an accounting firm in Dhaka. He has 12 years experience in financial management function in public and private sector.
3.4 Is the IP's accounting/finance function staffed adequately to ensure sufficient controls are in place to manage agency funds?	Yes			Low	1	It appears to us that ICT Division is adequately staffed to manage agency funds.
3.5 Does the IP have training policies for accounting/finance/ programme management staff? Are necessary training activities undertaken?	Yes			Low	1	ICT Division follows training policies issued by the Ministry of Public Administration (MOPA) as well as Ministry of Post, Telecommunications and Information Technology. Moreover, necessary training activities are undertaken as per RTPP/DPP.
3.6 Does the IP perform background verification/checks on all new accounting/finance and management positions?	Yes			Low	1	Background verification/checks is done as per policies issued by the Ministry of Administration (MOPA).

3.7 Has there been significant turnover in key finance positions the past five years? If so, has the rate improved or worsened and appears to be a problem?		No		Low	1	There was no significant turnover in key finance position.
3.8 Does the IP have a documented internal control framework? Is this framework distributed and made available to staff and updated periodically? If so, please describe.	Yes			Low	1	General system of financial management and control is documented in General Financial Rules of the Ministry of Finance.
Total number of questions in subject area:	**8**					
Total number of applicable questions in subject area:	**8**					
Total number of applicable key questions in subject area:	**3**					
Total number of risk points:	**8**					
Risk score	**1.000**					
Area risk rating	**Low**					

Subject area *(key questions in **bold**)*	**Yes**	**No**	**N/A**	**Risk Assessment**	**Risk points**	**Remarks/comments**
4. Accounting Policies and Procedures						
4a. General						
4.1 Does the IP have an accounting system that allows for proper recording of financial transactions from United Nations agencies, including allocation of expenditures in accordance with the respective components, disbursement categories and sources of funds?	Yes			Moderate	4	ICT Division maintains manual accounting system. Cash Book, Cheque Register, Bill Register etc. is maintained. However, Cash Book was not shown at the time of assessment on July 26, 2018. a2i-II project maintains accounts using accounting software (ATLAS) for UNDP funds and in excel for GOB funds. The accounts of a2i-II project is maintained in accordance with UNDP NEX Manual.
4.2 Does the IP have an appropriate cost allocation methodology that ensures accurate cost allocations to the various funding sources in accordance with established agreements?	Yes			Low	1	Cost allocation has been done as per RTPP/DPP.

4.3 Are all accounting and supporting documents retained in an organized system that allows authorized users easy access?	Yes			Low	1	Accounting and supporting documents are retained as per treasury rule and financial policies of the Govt.
4.4 Are the general ledger and subsidiary ledgers reconciled at least monthly? Are explanations provided for significant reconciling items?			N/A	N/A	-	According to the Treasury Rules, each Government Agency is required to maintain Cash Book.
4b. Segregation of duties						
4.5 Are the following functional responsibilities performed by different units or individuals: (a) authorization to execute a transaction; (b) recording of the transaction; and (c) custody of assets involved in the transaction?	Yes			Low	1	Deputy Secretary, Research and Scholarship Section approves vouchers of ICT Division. Finance Expert prepares vouchers of a2i-II project and the Project Director approves the vouchers. Consultant-Finance makes entry in the Cash Book pertaining to GOB funds of the project. Finance Officer maintains stock records.
4.6 Are the functions of ordering, receiving, accounting for and paying for goods and services appropriately segregated?	Yes			Moderate	4	Md. Kamruzzaman, Deputy Secretary (Logistic Service Section) issues purchase order of ICT Division, Store Keeper receives goods and records inventories, Accounts Officer/Assistant Accounts Officer maintains Cash Book and Cashier makes payment. Project Director issues purchase order of a2i-II project, Technical Committee/Logistic Department/Consultant receives goods, Consultant-Finance makes accounting entry, Finance Officer keeps inventory records and Finance Assistant makes payment.
4.7 Are bank reconciliations prepared by individuals other than those who make or approve payments?	Yes			Moderate	4	Bank Reconciliation Statement is not prepared at ICT Division. Bank Reconciliation Statement is prepared by the Finance Expert, reviewed by the Admin Specialist and approved by the Project Director in a2i-II project.
4c. Budgeting system						
4.8 Are budgets prepared for all activities in sufficient detail to provide a meaningful tool for monitoring subsequent performance?	Yes			Low	1	Project budget lays down physical and financial targets and is included in RTPP/DPP.
4.9 Are actual expenditures compared to the budget with reasonable frequency? Are explanations required for significant variations from the budget?	Yes			Low	1	Quarterly Progress Report is prepared and target and achievement is included in the report.

4.10 Is prior approval sought for budget amendments in a timely way?	Yes			Low	1	Due approval is taken from the development partner and Ministry of Finance for budget amendments and is included in RTPP/RDPP.
4.11 Are IP budgets approved formally at an appropriate level?	Yes			Low	1	The budget is recommended by the Secretary, ICT Division, Ministry of Post, Telecommunications and information Technology and approved by the Ministry of Finance.
4d. Payments						
4.12 Do invoice processing procedures provide for: **· Copies of purchase orders and receiving reports to be obtained directly from issuing departments?** **· Comparison of invoice quantities, prices and terms with those indicated on the purchase order and with records of goods/services actually received?** **· Checking the accuracy of calculations?**	Yes			Low	1	ICT generally follows Public Procurement Rules, 2008 while procuring goods and services.
4.13 Are payments authorized at an appropriate level? Does the IP have a table of payment approval thresholds?	Yes			Low	1	All payments of ICT Division are examined by the Accounts Officer and Deputy Secretary (Logistic Service Section) and approved by the Deputy Secretary, Research and Scholarship Section, who is the DDO. In case of a2i-II project, Finance Expert examines payments, which are then approved by the Project Director.
4.14 Are all invoices stamped '*PAID*', approved, and marked with the project code and account code?		No		Significant	6	All invoices pertaining to UNDP Fund are stamped 'PAID' only.
4.15 Do controls exist for preparation and approval of payroll expenditures? Are payroll changes properly authorized?	Yes			Low	1	Payroll is prepared as per attendance records and is approved by the Project Director.
4.16 Do controls exist to ensure that direct staff salary costs reflects the actual amount of staff time spent on a project?	Yes			Low	1	Attendance records are maintained for the project staff.
4.17 Do controls exist for expense categories that do not originate from invoice payments, such as DSAs, travel, and internal cost allocations?	Yes			Low	1	Bills are prepared as per prescribed rate as mentioned in the RTPP/DPP.
4e. Policies and procedures						
4.18 Does the IP have a stated basis of accounting (i.e. cash or accrual) and does it allow for compliance with the agency's requirement?	Yes			Low	1	ICT Division follows cash basis of accounting.

4.19 Does the IP have an adequate policies and procedures manual and is it distributed to relevant staff?	Yes			Low	1	ICT Division generally follows policies and procedures issued by the Ministry of Finance, Ministry of Public Administration and Ministry of Post, Telecommunications and Information Technology of the Government of Bangladesh.
4f. Cash and bank						
4.20 Does the IP require dual signatories/authorization for bank transactions? Are new signatories approved at an appropriate level and timely updates made when signatories depart?	Yes			Moderate	4	Deputy Secretary, Research and Scholarship Section is the sole signatory to the bank account of ICT Division as he is the DDO. However, in case of a2i-II project, any two of the Project Director, Policy Advisor and Administration Specialist is the signatory to the bank account.
4.21 Does the IP maintain an adequate, up-to-date cashbook, recording receipts and payments?	Yes			Moderate	4	Cash Book of ICT Division was not produced to us at the time of assessment. However, a2i-II maintains Cash Book.
4.22 If the partner is participating in micro-finance advances, do controls exist for the collection, timely deposit and recording of receipts at each collection location?	Yes			Low	1	Advances are timely realized/adjusted.
4.23 Are bank balances and cash ledger reconciled monthly and properly approved? Are explanations provided for significant, unusual and aged reconciling items?	Yes			Moderate	4	Bank Reconciliation Statement of ICT Division is not prepared. However, a2i-II project prepares Bank Reconciliation Statement monthly. Aged (few days) reconciling items with explanation are listed in the Bank Reconciliation Statement.
4.24 Is substantial expenditure paid in cash? If so, does the IP have adequate controls over cash payments?		No		Low	1	All substantial expenditures are paid by account payee cheque.
4.25 Does the IP carry out a regular petty cash reconciliation?	Yes			Low	1	Petty cash is balanced.
4.26 Are cash and cheques maintained in a secure location with restricted access? Are bank accounts protected with appropriate remote access controls?	Yes			Low	1	Cash and cheque books are kept in volt.
4.27 Are there adequate controls over submission of electronic payment files that ensure no unauthorized amendments once payments are approved and files are transmitted over secure/encrypted networks?			N/A	N/A	-	
4g. Other offices or entities						
4.28 Does the IP have a process to ensure expenditures of subsidiary offices/ external entities are in compliance with the work plan and/or contractual agreement?	Yes			Low	1	Oversight and monitoring of implementing entities is guided by the Allocation of Business

						among the different Ministries and Divisions (Rules of Business).
4h. Internal audit						
4.29 Is the internal auditor sufficiently independent to make critical assessments? To whom does the internal auditor report?			N/A	N/A	-	The questions under the Subject Area are not applicable to public sector financial management. However, expenditures pertaining to GOB fund are pre-audited by the Office of the Chief Accounts Officer, Information and Communication Technology Division, Ministry of Post, Telecommunications and Information Technology.
4.30 Does the IP have stated qualifications and experience requirements for internal audit department staff?			N/A	N/A	-	Please see our remarks/comments in Subject Area: 4.29 above.
4.31 Are the activities financed by the agencies included in the internal audit department's work programme?			N/A	N/A	-	Please see our remarks/comments in Subject Area: 4.29 above.
4.32 Does the IP act on the internal auditor's recommendations?			N/A	N/A	-	Please see our remarks/comments in Subject Area: 4.29 above.
Total number of questions in subject area:	**32**					
Total number of applicable questions in subject area:	**26**					
Total number of applicable key questions in subject area:	**19**					
Total number of risk points:	**49**					
Risk score	**1.885**					
Area risk rating	**Low**					

Subject area *(key questions in **bold**)*	**Yes**	**No**	**N/A**	**Risk Assessment**	**Risk points**	**Remarks/comments**
5. Fixed Assets and Inventory						
5a. Safeguards over assets						
5.1 Is there a system of adequate safeguards to protect assets from fraud, waste and abuse?	Yes			Low	1	A register/ledger is maintained to record fixed assets and inventories of ICT Division. Identification number was also assigned to fixed assets.

5.2 Are subsidiary records of fixed assets and inventory kept up to date and reconciled with control accounts?		No		High	4	The records of inventories are kept. But it is not reconciled with the accounts.
5.3 Are there periodic physical verification and/or count of fixed assets and inventory? If so, please describe?	Yes			Low	1	Physical verification of fixed assets pertaining to a2i-II project is done.
5.4 Are fixed assets and inventory adequately covered by insurance policies?		No		Significant	3	Only motor vehicles are covered by insurance policy.
5b. Warehousing and inventory management						
5.5 Do warehouse facilities have adequate physical security?		No		High	8	Warehouse of a2i-II project is rented in a flat at House no. 63/3/1, West Agargaon. It was not adequately secured.
5.6 Is inventory stored so that it is identifiable, protected from damage, and countable?		No		High	4	Store items were not found easily identifiable.
5.7 Does the IP have an inventory management system that enables monitoring of supply distribution?	Yes			Low	1	Stock Ledger is maintained to record receipt and issues of stock items.
5.8 Is responsibility for receiving and issuing inventory segregated from that for updating the inventory records?		No		High	4	Store-keeper receives and issues goods and keep inventory records in ICT Division.
5.9 Are regular physical counts of inventory carried out?		No		High	4	Physical count of inventories is not done.
Total number of questions in subject area:	**9**					
Total number of applicable questions in subject area:	**9**					
Total number of applicable key questions in subject area:	**2**					
Total number of risk points:	**30**					
Risk score	**3.333**					
Area risk rating	**Significant**					

Subject area *(key questions in **bold**)*	**Yes**	**No**	**N/A**	**Risk Assessment**	**Risk points**	**Remarks/comments**
6. Financial Reporting and Monitoring						
6.1 Does the IP have established financial reporting procedures that specify what reports are to be prepared, the source system for key reports, the frequency of preparation, what they are to contain and how they are to be used?	Yes			Low	1	According to financial reporting procedures, Quarterly Progress Report is prepared and target and achievement is included in the report. The management of the project uses report mainly to see the actual progress of the

						projects and take necessary decision for successful implementation of the projects.
6.2 Does the IP prepare overall financial statements?	Yes			Low	1	Project financial statement is prepared annually.
6.3 Are the IP's overall financial statements audited regularly by an independent auditor in accordance with appropriate national or international auditing standards? If so, please describe the auditor.	Yes			Low	1	Project financial statement is audited by the Foreign Aided Projects Audit Directorate (FAPAD) of the Government of Bangladesh.
6.4 Were there any major issues related to ineligible expenditure involving donor funds reported in the audit reports of the IP over the past three years?		No		Low	1	FAPAD issued unqualified audit report.
6.5 Have any significant recommendations made by auditors in the prior five audit reports and/or management letters over the past five years and have not yet been implemented?		No		Low	1	No such instance was reported in the audit report.
6.6 Is the financial management system computerized?		No		High	8	ICT Division maintains accounts manually. Financial management system of a2i-II project is not fully computerized.
6.7 Can the computerized financial management system produce the necessary financial reports?		No		High	4	Please see our remarks and comments in Subject Area: 6.6 above.
6.8 Does the IP have appropriate safeguards to ensure the confidentiality, integrity and availability of the financial data? *E.g. password access controls; regular data back-up.*	Yes			Low	1	Pass word, Cloud hard drive is maintained.
Total number of questions in subject area:	**8**					
Total number of applicable questions in subject area:	**8**					
Total number of applicable key questions in subject area:	**3**					
Total number of risk points:	**18**					
Risk score	**2.250**					
Area risk rating	**Moderate**					

Subject area *(key questions in **bold**)*	Yes	No	N/A	Risk Assessment	Risk points	Remarks/comments
7. Procurement and Contract Administration						
7a. Procurement						
7.1 Does the IP have written procurement policies and procedures?	Yes			Low	1	The Public Procurement Act, 2006 and the Public Procurement Rules, 2008 is followed.
7.2 Are exceptions to procurement procedures approved by management and documented?	Yes			Low	1	Any exception to the procurement procedure is approved as per the Public Procurement Act, 2006 and the Public Procurement Rules, 2008.
7.3 Does the IP have a computerized procurement system with adequate access controls and segregation of duties between entering purchase orders, approval and receipting of goods? Provide a description of the procurement system.		No		High	4	Procurement system is not computerized.
7.4 Are procurement reports generated and reviewed regularly? Describe reports generated, frequency and review & approvers.	Yes			Low	1	Procurement report is prepared.
7.5 Does the IP have a structured procurement unit with defined reporting lines that foster efficiency and accountability?	Yes			Low	1	A2i-II project has a Procurement Team consisting of Consultant and Procurement Associate. Besides, Tender Evaluation Committees are formed to procure large and small value of goods/works/services.
7.6 Is the IP's procurement unit resourced with qualified staff who are trained and certified and considered experts in procurement and conversant with UN/World Bank/European Union procurement requirements in addition to the IP's procurement rules and regulations?	Yes			Low	1	The procurement personnel are conversant with the GOB and UN procurement requirements.
7.7 Have any significant recommendations related to procurement made by auditors in the prior five audit reports and/or management letters over the past five years and have not yet been implemented?		No		Low	1	No such recommendation was reported in the FAPAD audit report.
7.8 Does the IP require written or system authorizations for purchases? If so, evaluate if the authorization thresholds are appropriate?	Yes			Low	1	The authorization thresholds as per Public Procurement Rules, 2008 are followed.
7.9 Do the procurement procedures and templates of contracts integrate references to ethical procurement principles and exclusion and ineligibility criteria?	Yes			Low	1	These all are addressed in the Public Procurement Act, 2006 and the Public Procurement Rules, 2008.

7.10 Does the IP obtain sufficient approvals before signing a contract?	Yes			Low	1	Tender Evaluation Committee analyses bids and recommends for purchase and the Project Director issues Purchase Order.
7.11 Does the IP have and apply formal guidelines and procedures to assist in identifying, monitoring and dealing with potential conflicts of interest with potential suppliers/procurement agents? If so, how does the IP proceed in cases of conflict of interest?	Yes			Low	1	The Public Procurement Rules, 2008 is followed. According to the PPR, Procuring Entity officials, who have an interest, directly or indirectly, with a firm or individual that is tendering or has tendered for a procurement proceedings of that Entity shall declare its relationship with that firm or individual and consequently not participate in any proceedings concerned with that specific procurement at any stage including from when the specifications are written and qualification criteria are established up to the Supply of Goods or performance of the Works are completed and, until all contractual obligations have been fulfilled.
7.12 Does the IP follow a well-defined process for sourcing suppliers? Do formal procurement methods include wide broadcasting of procurement opportunities?	Yes			Low	1	The Public Procurement Act, 2006 and the Public Procurement Rules, 2008 is followed.
7.13 Does the IP keep track of past performance of suppliers? E.g. database of trusted suppliers.	Yes			Low	1	List of suppliers are kept.
7.14 Does the IP follow a well-defined process to ensure a secure and transparent bid and evaluation process? If so, describe the process.	Yes			Low	1	The Public Procurement Act, 2006 and the Public Procurement Rules (PPR), 2008 is followed. Tender Opening Committee, Tender Evaluation Committee etc. is formed as per PPR.
7.15 When a formal invitation to bid has been issued, does the IP award the contract on a pre-defined basis set out in the solicitation documentation taking into account technical responsiveness and price?	Yes			Low	1	Technical responsiveness and cost is considered before awarding purchase order to the vendor.
7.16 If the IP is managing major contracts, does the IP have a policy on contracts management/administration?	Yes			Low	1	Contract management/administration is done as per Public Procurement Rules (PPR), 2008.
7b. Contract Management - To be completed only for the IPs managing contracts as part of programme implementation. Otherwise select N/A for risk assessment						
7.17 Are there personnel specifically designated to manage contracts or monitor contract expirations?	Yes			Low	1	Procurement team is responsible to manage contracts and monitor contract expirations.

7.18 Are there staff designated to monitor expiration of performance securities, warranties, liquidated damages and other risk management instruments?	Yes			Low	1	Procurement Associate is designated to monitor expiration of performance securities, warranties, liquidated damage etc.
7.19 Does the IP have a policy on post-facto actions on contracts?			N/A	N/A	-	
7.20 How frequent do post-facto contract actions occur?			N/A	N/A	-	

Total number of questions in subject area:	**20**
Total number of applicable questions in subject area:	**18**
Total number of applicable key questions in subject area:	**5**
Total number of risk points:	**21**
Risk score	**1.167**
Area risk rating	**Low**

Totals	
Total number of questions:	**96**
Total number of applicable questions:	**83**
Total number of applicable key questions:	**35**
Total number of risk points:	**143**
Total risk score	**1.723**
Overall risk rating	**Low**

-End-

Annex V: Gender Strategy

PURPOSE & APPROACH

a2i's gender strategy document defines the expectations of, serves as a guide for, and holds accountable the staff to integrate gender equality and women's empowerment in all aspects of the programme. Thereby it reinforces a2i's slogan "Innovate for All" where participation for underserved women and men will be equally ensured. This strategy articulates the objective of proactive gender- responsiveness in the offices and programmes.

The development of a gender strategy means that objectives, outputs, and gender-sensitive indicators are linked. This strategy will ensure that all stakeholders have the necessary level of understanding of gender equality and women's empowerment thereby increasing the positive impact of the programme. This strategy will include internalizing the gender strategy among a2i staff; fostering understanding of gender equity and an inclusive approach in programmatic interventions; development of gender-responsive institutions; and collaborations that are sensitive to gender equality considerations. Affirmative actions will be considered in all pillars and to ensure the effective implementation of the strategy and innovative issues such as gender dashboard, crowdsourcing, competition, crowd-funding etc., will be encouraged in all aspects of a2i programme.

4 PILLARS

By advancing gender equality and women's empowerment, this strategy envisages more inclusive and gender-sensitive public and private sectors. This strategy is therefore anchored by four pillars, which reflect key features of the a2i programme:

- Internal procedures
- Programmatic Interventions
- Institutional Behaviour Change
- Partnerships

Pillar 1: Internal Procedures

This strategy will be implemented by integrating approaches and actions that assure equal opportunities for female and male staff within a female-friendly work environment. In order to achieve that, the following actions need to be addressed:

- Align a2i's gender strategy with a2i structures, policies and systems and promote gender responsive leadership by a2i in senior management.
- Ensure staff knowledge, skills and attitudes on gender equality and include this strategy in staff work plans; accountability and performance appraisals; and in their annual budgets.
- Provide training on sexual harassment and gender discrimination in the workplace to ensure better understanding of these issues.

Pillar 2: Programmatic Intervention

The new project will integrate gender considerations with the project intervention. This strategy will integrate inclusiveness of all women and men, girls and boys, regardless of ethnicity, disability and indigenous status.[10] Gender equality will be identified and promoted in all strategic plans and programmatic action & activities from problem identification to programme implementation in the following way:

- Collect sex-aggregated data;
- Regular analysis of data and ensure gender sensitive project intervention;
- Gender responsive public investment to promote self-employment and employment generation of underserved women and men;

10) ,UNDP Gender Equality Strategy)2014-2017(http://www.undp.org/content/undp/en/home/librarypage/womens-empowerment/gender-equality-strategy-.2017-2014html(

- Review policies, rules and technological standards/interventions for ensuring the ability of easy access of product and e-services for underserved women and men;
- Ensure financial accessibility to underserved women and men;
- Expand the scalability of the initiatives of innovation and e-service delivery that also demonstrate a proactive gender responsiveness and women's empowerment.
- Encourage gender responsive initiatives in innovation fund from GoB, political leaders, private sector, civil society, academia, industry and media etc.

■ Pillar 3: Institutional Behavioural Change

This strategy states that a2i will facilitate the creation of an enabling environment for behavioural change and increased leadership among government officials as well as other partners. The following actions will help to promote enabling environment for institutional behavioural change:

- Ensure gender leadership courses in all training manuals and increase gender responsiveness in e-service delivery of public institutions.
- Focus the gender leadership representation in all team formations and address the gender sensitive challenges and innovation for service design and implementation accordingly.
- Work with the gender focal points from all ministries/divisions that partner with the Ministry of Women and Children Affairs (MoWCA) to create an enabling environment for institutional behavioural change.
- Identify and incentivize administrative leaders as advocates and role models for gender equality.
- Employ various communication channels such as traditional media, social media and different ICT tools to create positive impact on the society.

■ Pillar 4: Partnerships

The strategy will help to build partnership across a wide range of stakeholders including government, political leaders, private sector, civil society, academia, media and other donors to ensure that our efforts are coordinated and will also promote gender equality and women's empowerment. The following actions will help promote gender responsive partnerships:

- Incorporate this strategy in all collaborations with all partners at all levels.
- Encourage change in partners who do not yet share our commitment to gender equality and women's empowerment.

Considering the 4 Pillars, the project will develop certain indicators to measure the progress on the strategic intervention in gender equality and women's empowerment.

24. Knowledge Management Officer:

The Knowledge Management Officer will develop the internal and external research management policy including report assessments, monitoring and evaluations, prepare articles/Presentations for international journals and conferences, conduct research to collect necessary data for the documentation, organize national and international events for collecting data and generating evidence, and sharing the results. S/he will also coordinate the overall documentation of the Results Management Team of the project, prepare quarterly/annual progress reports in line with donor requirements, manage data quality, data analysis and visualization, including BigData, disseminate a2i's results among national and international audiences while providing technical support to external consultants engaged in research, baseline, end-line and other evaluative assessments of the research project activities.

25. Learning Management Officer:

The Learning Management Officer will be responsible for leading the developing, updating and implementing actions of the Monitoring, Evaluation and Results Management Framework for the project and all its initiatives. H/ She will also coordinate and implement the M&E related activities of the project, lead to internal and external research, assessments and evaluations, create a system to capture, develop, share and effectively apply project's learning, contribute to the capacity development of project staff around the themes of monitoring and results management and maintaining external Results Management Network.

26. Chief Technology Officer

The Chief Technology Officer will responsible to manage, plan, analysis, design, development and implementation of solution architecture of national digital services with a focus on target population. He will provide advisory support to capacity development by coaching government ICT focal points as well as by collaborating with ICT industries on all issues related to ensuring proper function of the e-service systems. S/he will work closely with digital service projects in relevant ministries when necessary to guide them in technology management issues. S/he will also function as Principal Accounting Officer for technology management issues in digital service Component of the project. S/he will perform other related duties and responsibilities as and when required assigned by project management.

27. Technology Officer:

The Technology Officer will develop technological solutions under the supervision of Head of Innovation. S/he will provide assistance to the Head of Innovation. S/he will conduct a thorough study to identify the best technology options for the target population and ensure that the technological reality of the target population is properly incorporated in the plan, design and implementation of the technology solutions. The Technology Expert will also develop budgets for technology solutions and conduct any other function, responsibility which may be assigned by the Head of Innovation.

28. Solution Architect:

The Solution Architect will plan, analyse, design, develop and implement solution architecture of national digital services with a focus on target population while providing advisory to capacity development by coaching government ICT focal points as well as by collaborating with ICT industries on all issues related to ensuring proper function of the e-service systems. S/he will also closely work with digital service projects in relevant ministry when necessary. S/he will also function as an effective team member of digital service component of the project.

29. Business Development Specialist:

A Business Development Specialist will serve for G2B Service liaison with the Government, Business Community and the technical development team of Business Information Service Framework/G2B platform. The person will be responsible for eliciting, analysing, validating, specifying, verifying, and managing the business needs of the project stakeholders, including Government, Business Community and end users. S/he will work closely with Government officials, business units, subject matter experts and technical resources to identify business needs, define projects, develop requirements and manage the development effort to completion in the development of appropriate business process analysis for designing Business information Service Framework /G2B platform working under Technological Team of e -service.

30. Head of Operations/Operations Manager:

The Head of Operations will be responsible for the day to day operational management of the project, including developing and overseeing work & procurement plans and financial management. S/he is responsible for regular reporting to UNDP and GoB. As the head of programme operations, the incumbent will also keep the NPD abreast about the various operational aspects including the financial position of the project and will lead the procurement, human resources, finance and administrative units of the project.

31. Finance Specialist:

The Finance Specialist will be engaged with the project's activity management on ensuring availability of fund for activities of the project, ensuring programme financing for performing the programme smoothly, serving as liaison to UNDP and other development partners on fund mobilization, planning fund utilization and other related issues, providing monitoring role regarding all a2i activities performed in the field, procurement, finance and related activities. S/he will also ensure proper disbursement and monitoring of utilization of the Service Innovation Fund, lead Service Innovation funding team of the project and be primarily accountable for the administrative activities to senior management.

32. Procurement Specialist:

The Procurement Specialist will be responsible for the analytical and advisory activities (AAA) and technical assistance (TA) in the areas of procurement planning and management. S/he will oversee the procurement activities of the project, ensure high quality, reliable and responsive procurement business services complying the rules and regulations of GoB and UNDP. Procurement Specialist will supervise and manage procurement operations of the project.

33. Finance Officer:

The Finance Officer will report to the Head of Operations and provide support during the implementation of operational strategies. The incumbent will manage the project's budget, organize cost-recovery system, maintain expenditure control and deal with cash management. Besides, s/he will prepare and submit all financial reports for relevant authority. The incumbent will provide support to the Head of Operations in the preparation of detailed cost estimates, budget analysis and financial planning and provide necessary guidance in operating GoB funds.

34. Human Resources Officer:

Human Resources Officer will be responsible for facilitating the coordination between the project and UNDP country office in decision making areas relevance to various HR issues. S/he will provide support to the management in monitoring and management of the HR related activities of the project as well as implementing HR strategies and policies.

35. Procurement Officer:

Procurement Officer will provide support to the project management in procurement planning and management. S/he will oversee the procurement activities of the project, ensure high quality, reliable and responsive procurement business services complying the rules and regulations of UNDP.